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Lesson 19: SOCIAL COGNITION

Summarized Notes

Social Cognition

Social cognition refers to how people think about themselves, others, and social situations. Past events and expectations influence our social thinking and judgments. Social cognition helps us understand how people interpret and respond to the social world.

Thinking About the Past

Hindsight Bias

Hindsight bias is the tendency to believe that an event was predictable after it has already happened. People overestimate their ability to foresee outcomes. It develops because people want to create meaning and understanding from events. It usually does not occur for extremely unusual or bizarre events.

Counterfactual Thinking

Counterfactual thinking involves imagining alternative outcomes or “what if” situations. It commonly occurs after unexpected or negative events. People usually imagine easier changes (“downhill changes”) rather than difficult changes (“uphill changes”). It helps people feel better and prepare for future situations. Excessive counterfactual thinking can increase guilt and distress. Davis et al. (1996) found that people who repeatedly imagined how they could have prevented the loss of loved ones experienced more emotional distress.

How Expectations Shape Social Thinking

False Consensus Effect

False consensus is the tendency to believe that other people share our opinions, beliefs, and behaviors more than they actually do. People assume their own views are common in society. Ross, Greene, and House (1977) studied students’ predictions about wearing a sandwich board advertisement. Students who agreed to wear it believed many others would also agree. Students who refused believed many others would refuse.

Explanation of False Consensus Effect

Availability heuristic causes people to judge others using easily recalled information about themselves. Our own beliefs become the most available examples when judging others. False uniqueness belief is the tendency to underestimate how common our positive qualities are. False uniqueness is linked with self-serving bias.

Confirmation Bias

Confirmation bias is the tendency to search for information that supports existing beliefs. People ignore information that challenges their opinions.

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It can reduce effective problem solving when beliefs are incorrect.

Synder and Swann (1978) found that people asked questions supporting their initial assumptions about others.

Confirmation bias may occur because of mental shortcuts or the desire to maintain social relationships.

Self-Fulfilling Prophecy

Self-fulfilling prophecy occurs when expectations about a person or group lead to behaviors that make those expectations become true.

Rosenthal and Jacobson Study (1968)

Teachers were told that certain students were expected to improve academically.

These “bloomers” were randomly selected students.

After eight months, selected students showed greater IQ improvement.

Teachers’ expectations influenced students’ performance.

Development of Self-Fulfilling Prophecy

Perceiver forms expectations about the target.

Perceiver behaves toward the target according to expectations.

Target interprets these behaviors and responds in ways that confirm expectations.

Just World Hypothesis

Just world hypothesis is the belief that the world is fair and people receive what they deserve.

It creates an illusion of control by making people believe good actions lead to good outcomes.

Advantages

Improves psychological adjustment.

Strengthens relationships.

Reduces stress.

Disadvantages

Leads to defensive attribution.

People may blame victims for their suffering.

Helps maintain the belief that bad events happen only to bad people.

When faced with unfair events, people may respond with anger or revenge.

Learned Helplessness

Learned helplessness is passive resignation caused by repeated exposure to unavoidable negative events.

Initially, people experience anxiety, but repeated lack of control can lead to depression.

First discovered by Seligman and Maier (1967) through animal research.

Individual explanations about causes of failure determine whether helplessness develops.

Explanatory Styles

Pessimistic Explanatory Style

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Pessimists explain negative events through internal, stable, and global causes. They focus more on problems and failures.

Optimistic Explanatory Style

Optimists explain events through external, unstable, and specific causes. They focus on positive outcomes and solutions. Optimists usually have better immune functioning.

Peterson et al. (1988) Study

College graduates' wartime explanations were studied. People with pessimistic styles later showed more health problems. Cognitive therapy can help change negative self-attributions.

Applied Social Psychology Lab

Negative Event Explanations

People explain events using optimistic or pessimistic styles. Cognitive therapy helps people identify their role in successes and failures. Keeping success and failure diaries can improve self-attributions.

9/11 Social Judgment Example

Many people reported suspects based on stereotypes. Representativeness heuristic was used to judge suspects. Availability heuristic influenced people because examples of terrorism were easily remembered.

Important Exam Points

Social cognition explains how people think about themselves and others.

Hindsight bias occurs when people believe they predicted an event after it happened.

Counterfactual thinking means imagining alternative outcomes.

False consensus effect is overestimating the similarity between our own beliefs and others' beliefs.

Availability heuristic contributes to false consensus because personal beliefs are easily recalled.

Confirmation bias causes people to search for supporting information and ignore opposing evidence.

Rosenthal and Jacobson (1968) proved that teachers' expectations can influence students' performance.

Self-fulfilling prophecy involves expectations becoming reality through behavior.

Just world hypothesis creates the belief that people get what they deserve.

Defensive attribution leads people to blame victims for negative events.

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Learned helplessness was discovered by Seligman and Maier (1967).

Pessimistic explanatory style is linked with greater health problems.

Optimists generally show better psychological and physical health outcomes.

Representativeness heuristic and availability heuristic influence social judgments.

Statement MCQs

1. Hindsight bias refers to:

- A. Predicting future events accurately
- B. Believing after an event that we knew it would happen
- C. Ignoring past experiences
- D. Changing personal beliefs

Correct Answer: B

2. False consensus effect means:

- A. Believing everyone is different from us
- B. Ignoring social opinions
- C. Assuming others share our beliefs more than they actually do
- D. Rejecting personal opinions

Correct Answer: C

3. Confirmation bias causes people to:

- A. Search for information that supports their beliefs
- B. Accept all opposing information
- C. Avoid making decisions
- D. Forget past events

Correct Answer: A

4. Learned helplessness was first studied by:

- A. Rosenthal and Jacobson
- B. Ross and Greene
- C. Seligman and Maier
- D. Synder and Swann

Correct Answer: C

5. Self-fulfilling prophecy occurs when:

- A. People avoid expectations
- B. Expectations influence behavior and become reality

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- C. People forget social experiences
- D. People reject beliefs

Correct Answer: B

Psychological Statement Q/A

1. Why does hindsight bias occur?

Answer: Hindsight bias occurs because people want to make sense of events and believe outcomes were predictable after they happen.

2. Why do people use counterfactual thinking after negative events?

Answer: People use counterfactual thinking to reduce emotional pain, understand events, and prepare for future situations.

3. How does confirmation bias affect decision making?

Answer: Confirmation bias can reduce effective decision making because people focus only on information supporting their beliefs and ignore conflicting evidence.

4. Why can just world belief become harmful?

Answer: It can become harmful because people may blame victims for their suffering to maintain the belief that the world is fair.

5. How can cognitive therapy help learned helplessness?

Answer: Cognitive therapy helps people change negative explanations, recognize their successes, and develop healthier self-attributions.

Lesson 20: ATTITUDES

Summarized Notes

Aims

To introduce the concept of attitudes, components, and ways of assessment.

Objectives

To discuss definition of an attitude and its components.
To describe direct and indirect methods of assessing attitudes.

Evaluating Persons and Relationships

Discussion About New Section of Social Psychology

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This section focuses on the general study of attitude formation and change.
It includes specific attitudes such as negative attitudes of prejudice and discrimination and positive attitudes of interpersonal attractions and attachments.
It discusses causes of social intolerance and different forms of prejudice.
It also explains how positive attractions are formed.

What is an Attitude?

An attitude is a positive or negative evaluation of an object (Schuman, 1995), where an attitude object can be a person, thing, event, or issue.

The term attitude was first used in theatre, where it described body posture.
The concept dates back to the 1800s and later referred to a “posture of mind” rather than body posture.

According to Allport, attitude is the most indispensable concept of social psychology.
He stated that attitudes determine what an individual sees, hears, thinks, and does.
Attitudes give meaning to the world around us.

Three Components of Attitudes

Before the 1990s, attitudes were explained through three components called the tricomponent model.
This idea was based on “ABC” information.

Affective Component

Affective component refers to a person’s emotions and feelings toward an object.

Behavioral Component

Behavioral component refers to how a person tends to act toward an object.
Attitudes influence behavior but are not the only determinant of behavior.
Past behavior can also influence attitudes.

Cognitive Component

Cognitive component consists of the thoughts and beliefs a person has about an object.
Attitudes can be cognitively complex but evaluatively simple.

Modern View of Attitudes

Because all three components may not always be present, many psychologists focus on a single dimension definition of attitudes: evaluation.

Common words used for evaluating objects include:

Bad
Good
Dislike
Hate
Love

Special terms are used for specific attitudes.

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Self-esteem refers to attitude toward oneself.

Prejudice and discrimination are negative specific attitudes.

Interpersonal attraction and relationships are positive specific attitudes.

Prejudice is an attitude toward groups, whereas interpersonal attraction is directed toward individuals.

Although evaluation is the central component of attitudes, behavior and beliefs are also important.

Attitude Formation Processes

Attitudes develop through three different types of antecedents:

Behavioral processes

Affective processes

Cognitive processes

These processes contribute to the development of attitudes.

Assessing Attitudes

Direct Assessment

Direct assessment involves measuring attitudes by directly asking individuals about their opinions.

Three common methods are used:

1. Likert (Summated Ratings) Scales

Likert scales measure attitudes by asking individuals to rate their level of agreement or disagreement.

Example:

What is your opinion about co-education at college level?

Very much opposed → Very much in favor

2. Semantic Differential Scales

Semantic differential scales measure attitudes by using opposite descriptive terms.

Example:

How do you feel about the taste of this coffee?

Unpleasant _____ Pleasant

3. Latitude of Acceptance

Latitude of acceptance measures the range of opinions or options that a person finds acceptable.

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Respondents mark options they accept and reject.

Indirect Assessment

Indirect assessment developed because direct assessment can be affected by social desirability.

Social Desirability Problem

People may provide socially acceptable answers instead of their true attitudes.

Studies conducted in the 1930s and 1969 showed reduced stereotypes of White people against Black people.

However, evidence did not show a true reduction in prejudice.

This difference was explained by social desirability factors.

Bogus Pipeline Technique

Bogus pipeline technique convinces respondents that researchers can detect their real attitudes.

It is used to encourage honest responses.

It has been effective in helping people admit behaviors such as smoking, drinking too much, and other unhealthy behaviors.

Modern Methods of Attitude Assessment

Recent advances in electrophysiology may allow researchers to detect attitudes more directly.

Electromyography recordings can detect small changes in muscles that reflect a person's feelings and attitudes.

Important Exam Points

Attitude is a positive or negative evaluation of an object.

According to Allport, attitudes determine what people see, hear, think, and do.

The three components of attitudes are affective, behavioral, and cognitive.

Affective component refers to emotions toward an object.

Behavioral component refers to actions or tendencies toward an object.

Cognitive component refers to thoughts and beliefs about an object.

Modern psychologists often define attitudes as evaluations.

Prejudice is a negative attitude toward a group.

Interpersonal attraction is a positive attitude toward individuals.

Direct assessment measures attitudes by asking people directly.

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Likert scales, semantic differential scales, and latitude of acceptance are direct assessment methods.

Social desirability can influence direct attitude measurement.

Bogus pipeline technique helps reveal true attitudes.

Electromyography can detect emotional responses related to attitudes.

Statement MCQs

1. An attitude is:

- A. A physical posture only
- B. A positive or negative evaluation of an object
- C. A person's intelligence level
- D. A social behavior only

Correct Answer: B

2. The three components of attitudes are:

- A. Learning, memory, and thinking
- B. Affective, behavioral, and cognitive
- C. Social, personal, and emotional
- D. Internal, external, and biological

Correct Answer: B

3. The affective component refers to:

- A. Thoughts and beliefs
- B. Actions toward an object
- C. Emotions and feelings toward an object
- D. Social experiences

Correct Answer: C

4. Likert scales are used for:

- A. Measuring attitudes directly
- B. Measuring intelligence
- C. Studying personality disorders
- D. Measuring physical abilities

Correct Answer: A

5. Bogus pipeline technique is used to:

- A. Change attitudes permanently
- B. Detect real attitudes by convincing people their responses can be checked
- C. Study memory processes
- D. Measure intelligence

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Correct Answer: B

Psychological Statement Q/A

1. What is an attitude?

Answer: An attitude is a positive or negative evaluation of a person, thing, event, or issue.

2. What are the three components of attitudes?

Answer: The three components are affective (emotions), behavioral (actions), and cognitive (thoughts and beliefs).

3. Why are indirect methods used for assessing attitudes?

Answer: Indirect methods are used because direct methods can be affected by social desirability, causing people to give socially acceptable answers.

4. What is the purpose of the bogus pipeline technique?

Answer: The bogus pipeline technique is used to encourage people to reveal their true attitudes by making them believe their actual feelings can be detected.

5. How does electrophysiology help in attitude assessment?

Answer: Electrophysiology helps detect attitudes by measuring physiological responses, such as small muscle changes that reflect emotional reactions.

Lesson 21: ATTITUDE FORMATION

Summarized Notes

Aims

To introduce the main theoretical approaches to the study of attitudes.

Objectives

To evaluate the theories of attitude formation and function.

To understand the concepts through applied social psychology lab.

Attitude Formation

Different theories explain how attitudes are formed. These theories describe the processes through which people develop positive or negative evaluations toward objects, individuals, and events.

1. Mere Exposure Theory (Robert Zajonc, 1968)

Mere exposure refers to the tendency to develop more positive feelings toward objects and individuals the more we are exposed to them.

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No action or beliefs about the object are required.

Familiarity does not breed contempt; instead, repeated exposure often increases liking.

Zajonc Experiment (1968)

The experiment was conducted to determine how people learn a foreign language.

Participants were shown 10 Chinese-like characters on a computer screen for 2 seconds each.

The characters were presented different numbers of times.

Participants were asked whether the characters represented positive or negative adjectives.

The results showed that characters presented more frequently generated more positive attitudes among participants.

Mita, Dermer, and Knight Experiment (1977)

Participants were shown two photographs of themselves:

Actual image

Mirror image

The prints were identical in quality.

Participants were asked which image they preferred.

People preferred the mirror image because it was the view of themselves they saw most often.

Friends usually prefer the actual image because they see that view.

This explains why people often dislike photographs of themselves.

2. Classical Conditioning

Classical conditioning occurs when a neutral stimulus is paired with a stimulus that naturally produces an emotional response.

It involves learning through association.

Arthur and Carolyn Staats (1962) were the first researchers to investigate classical conditioning in relation to attitudes.

Classical conditioning may contribute to attitude formation but cannot completely explain all aspects of attitudes.

A stronger effect occurs when unpleasant stimuli are paired with meaningless words (Cacioppo, Marshall-Goodell, Tassinari, & Petty, 1992).

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Classical conditioning becomes more influential when little information is available about the attitude object.

Staats and Staats Study (1958)

The study showed that pairing positive or negative words with different nationalities influenced attitudes toward those groups.

Positive words increased favorable attitudes.

Negative words increased unfavorable attitudes.

Subliminal Conditioning

Subliminal conditioning is classical conditioning that occurs without conscious awareness of the stimulus.

Krosnick et al. (1992) Study

College students were shown photographs of a stranger performing daily activities.

Before the photographs, participants were briefly exposed to positive or negative emotional images.

Participants exposed to positive images developed more positive attitudes toward the stranger.

3. Operant Conditioning

Operant conditioning occurs when behavior is strengthened through rewards and weakened through punishments.

For example, a student may develop a positive attitude toward mathematics if praised for efforts.

If efforts are ignored, the student may lose interest and performance may decline.

Classical conditioning is related to the affective component of attitudes.

Operant conditioning is related to the behavioral component of attitudes.

Attitudes can also develop through observational learning (Bandura, 1986).

Observational Learning

People learn attitudes and behaviors by observing others.

For example, if a person experiences a car accident and avoids driving, this occurs through direct experience.

If another person develops fear of driving by observing the accident, it occurs through observational learning.

Children learn many behaviors, skills, family practices, and cultural values through observation.

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4. Self-Perception Theory (Bem, 1965)

Self-perception theory states that people infer their attitudes by observing their own behaviors.

People use their behavior as evidence about their feelings and beliefs.

This involves attributional processes where individuals interpret their own actions as indicators of attitudes.

Bem suggested that people are more likely to make attitude judgments when their behavior is freely chosen.

Chaiken and Baldwin Study (1981)

Researchers studied self-perception theory by dividing participants into two groups:

Strong pro-environmental attitude group.

Weak pro-environmental attitude group.

Participants were asked to support either pro-environmental or anti-environmental statements.

Results showed that participants who reported pro-environmental behaviors developed more positive environmental attitudes.

This effect occurred mainly among participants who originally had weak environmental attitudes.

Facial Feedback Theory

Strack, Martin, and Stepper Study (1988)

Researchers studied the effect of facial expressions on attitudes.

Participants watched cartoons while holding a pen in different positions:

Pen in teeth position (similar to smiling).

Pen in lips position (prevents smiling).

Pen in non-dominant hand.

Participants later rated their attitudes toward the cartoons.

Results showed that participants holding the pen in their teeth showed greater liking for cartoons.

This supported the facial feedback hypothesis.

Vascular Theory of Emotion (Zajonc, 1993)

Smiling increases the flow of air-cooled blood to the brain, producing a pleasant mood.

Frowning reduces blood flow and promotes negative mood.

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Research showed that even pronunciation of vowel sounds could influence facial muscles and mood.

Other body postures can also influence attitudes.

Stepper and Strack (1993) found that sitting upright produced more positive attitudes compared with slumped postures.

5. Functional Theory of Attitudes

Functional theory explains that attitudes develop and change according to the psychological needs they satisfy.

People may change attitudes when an object no longer fulfills their needs.

Example:

A person may change from liking to disliking a coffee brand because of its harmful environmental practices.

Active vs Passive Attitude Theory

Attitudes can develop through active experiences or passive influences from the environment.

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Performing actions associated with happiness can increase feelings of happiness and cause people to evaluate their environment more positively.

Body posture can influence emotional states and attitudes.

This explains why parents encourage children to maintain good posture and avoid slouching.

Important Exam Points

Mere exposure theory was proposed by Robert Zajonc (1968).

Repeated exposure increases positive feelings toward objects and individuals.

Classical conditioning develops attitudes through association.

Subliminal conditioning occurs without conscious awareness.

Operant conditioning develops attitudes through rewards and punishments.

Classical conditioning is linked with the affective component of attitudes.

Operant conditioning is linked with the behavioral component of attitudes.

Observational learning helps people acquire attitudes by observing others.

Self-perception theory explains that people infer attitudes by observing their own behavior.

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Bem proposed self-perception theory in 1965.

Facial feedback theory suggests facial expressions can influence emotions and attitudes.

Strack, Martin, and Stepper (1988) supported facial feedback theory.

Zajonc (1993) proposed the vascular theory of emotion.

Functional theory explains that attitudes satisfy psychological needs.

Statement MCQs

1. Mere exposure effect was proposed by:

- A. Bem
- B. Robert Zajonc
- C. Bandura
- D. Allport

Correct Answer: B

2. Classical conditioning involves:

- A. Learning through association
- B. Learning through punishment only
- C. Observing others only
- D. Forgetting previous experiences

Correct Answer: A

3. Operant conditioning is based on:

- A. Rewards and punishments
- B. Genetic factors
- C. Memory processes
- D. Biological changes only

Correct Answer: A

4. Self-perception theory was proposed by:

- A. Zajonc
- B. Bem
- C. Staats
- D. Bandura

Correct Answer: B

5. Facial feedback theory suggests that:

- A. Behavior has no effect on attitudes
- B. Facial expressions can influence emotions and attitudes

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- C. Attitudes cannot change
- D. Learning does not affect attitudes

Correct Answer: B

Psychological Statement Q/A

1. What is the mere exposure effect?

Answer: Mere exposure effect is the tendency to develop more positive feelings toward objects or people through repeated exposure.

2. How does classical conditioning influence attitude formation?

Answer: Classical conditioning influences attitudes by creating associations between neutral stimuli and emotional responses.

3. How does operant conditioning develop attitudes?

Answer: Operant conditioning develops attitudes through rewards that strengthen behaviors and punishments that weaken them.

4. What does self-perception theory explain?

Answer: Self-perception theory explains that people understand their attitudes by observing their own behaviors.

5. How does facial feedback influence attitudes?

Answer: Facial feedback influences attitudes because facial expressions can affect emotional states and evaluations of objects.

Lesson 22: ATTITUDE AND BEHAVIOR

Summarized Notes

Aims

Introducing the concept of the relationship between attitude and behavior.

Objectives

To describe models of the relationship between attitudes and behavior.

To understand factors determining the link between attitude and behavior.

The Attitude-Behavior Relationship

During the 1970s, a crisis of confidence developed regarding the concept of attitudes because researchers found a weak relationship between attitudes and behavior.

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Psychologists questioned whether attitudes should still be considered a central concept in social psychology.

The difficulty was first demonstrated by LaPierre in 1934.

LaPierre Study (1934)

At that time, there was widespread prejudice against Asians in the United States.

LaPierre traveled across the U.S. with a young Chinese couple for three months.

The main question was whether restaurant and hotel managers would refuse service to the couple.

Results:

Only 1 out of 66 hotels refused to provide service.

Only 1 out of 250 restaurants refused service.

Later, letters were sent to hotels and restaurants asking if they would serve Chinese people.

Out of 128 replies, 90% stated that they would refuse service to Chinese people.

This study showed that attitudes and behavior do not always match.

When Do Attitudes Predict Behavior?

Several factors influence the relationship between attitudes and behavior:

Specificity

Test-retest reliability

Private vs. public self-awareness

Attitude strength

Attitude accessibility

1. Specificity

In LaPierre's study, behavior was specific because it involved serving a particular Chinese couple.

However, the attitude measured was general because it asked about serving Chinese people in general.

Specific attitudes are more likely to predict specific behaviors.

Specific attitude → Specific behavior

2. Test-Retest Reliability

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The longer the time between measuring an attitude and observing behavior, the more likely the attitude may change.

Therefore, recent attitude measurements are more accurate predictors of behavior.

3. Private vs. Public Self-Awareness

Self-awareness influences whether people act according to their personal attitudes or social expectations.

Private Self-Awareness

Privately self-aware individuals behave according to their own attitudes.

Public Self-Awareness

Publicly self-aware individuals behave according to socially accepted attitudes.

Froming et al. Study (1982)

Researchers first measured students' attitudes toward physical punishment.

Students with negative attitudes toward physical punishment were selected.

Later, participants were asked to administer shocks to other people.

Results showed that behavior depended on the type of self-awareness.

Participants who were privately self-aware and looking at themselves in a mirror administered lower intensity shocks.

Participants facing an audience behaved according to public expectations.

4. Attitude Strength

Stronger attitudes are more likely to influence behavior.

Attitude strength increases through:

Greater information about the attitude object.

Greater personal involvement with the attitude object.

Greater direct experience with the attitude object.

Direct experience activates all three components of attitudes:

Affective component

Cognitive component

Behavioral component

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All these factors increase attitude strength and attitude-behavior consistency.

Kallgren and Wood Study (1986)

Researchers studied the relationship between environmental attitudes, knowledge, and behavior.

Participants were first questioned about environmental attitudes and knowledge.

Later, they were asked to participate in pro-environmental activities.

People with greater environmental knowledge showed stronger consistency between attitudes and behavior.

5. Attitude Accessibility

Attitude accessibility refers to how easily an attitude comes to mind.

The availability heuristic influences accessibility because people judge situations using easily recalled information.

The more accessible an attitude is, the stronger the relationship between attitude and behavior.

Fazio and Williams (1986) measured attitude accessibility through the speed of responses to questions about attitude objects.

Theory of Planned Behavior (Fishbein & Ajzen, 1975)

The theory of planned behavior explains that conscious decisions and intentions to perform actions are influenced by three factors.

1. Determinants of Attitudes

These include:

Beliefs about the consequences of performing a behavior.

Evaluation of possible consequences.

Example:

A person believes quitting smoking will improve health and evaluates this outcome positively.

2. Determinants of Subjective Norms

Subjective norms involve:

Perceived expectations of important people.

Motivation to follow these expectations.

Example:

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Family members encourage a person to quit smoking.

3. Determinants of Perceived Behavioral Control

Perceived behavioral control refers to how easy or difficult a person believes performing a behavior will be.

Example:

A smoker may want to quit but feel unable because of addiction.

Theory of Planned Behavior Example

Attitude toward behavior:

I want to stop smoking.

Subjective norms:

My family wants me to stop smoking.

Perceived behavioral control:

I am addicted and quitting is difficult.

If one factor strongly opposes the behavior, intention becomes weak and the behavior may not occur.

Theory of Planned Behavior Model

Attitude toward a behavior

-

Subjective norms

-

Perceived behavioral control

↓

Intention

↓

Behavior

Criticism of Theory of Planned Behavior

The theory explains planned and logical behaviors well but has limitations.

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Spontaneous Behavior

Some behaviors occur automatically without conscious planning.

Example:

Responding based on easily accessible attitudes.

Habits

Habits involve little reasoning or conscious decision-making.

The theory cannot fully explain automatic behaviors because people often act without careful thought.

Humans are considered cognitive misers because they often use mental shortcuts.

Important Exam Points

LaPierre (1934) showed that attitudes do not always predict behavior.

The attitude-behavior relationship depends on specificity, reliability, self-awareness, attitude strength, and accessibility.

Specific attitudes are better predictors of specific behaviors.

Private self-awareness causes people to act according to personal attitudes.

Public self-awareness causes people to act according to social expectations.

Strong attitudes are more likely to influence behavior.

Direct experience strengthens attitudes because it involves affective, cognitive, and behavioral components.

Kallgren and Wood (1986) studied consistency between environmental attitudes and behavior.

Accessible attitudes have a stronger relationship with behavior.

Fishbein and Ajzen (1975) proposed the Theory of Planned Behavior.

Theory of Planned Behavior includes attitudes, subjective norms, and perceived behavioral control.

Intentions are important predictors of planned behavior.

The theory does not fully explain spontaneous and habitual behaviors.

Statement MCQs

1. LaPierre's study showed that:

- A. Attitudes always predict behavior
- B. Attitudes and behavior may not always match

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- C. Behavior never changes attitudes
- D. Social situations have no effect

Correct Answer: B

2. Specific attitudes predict:

- A. General behavior
- B. Specific behavior
- C. Personality traits
- D. Intelligence

Correct Answer: B

3. Private self-awareness causes people to:

- A. Follow social expectations only
- B. Behave according to their own attitudes
- C. Ignore attitudes completely
- D. Avoid behavior

Correct Answer: B

4. Theory of Planned Behavior was proposed by:

- A. Bandura and Bem
- B. Fishbein and Ajzen
- C. LaPierre and Fazio
- D. Zajonc and Staats

Correct Answer: B

5. Theory of Planned Behavior includes:

- A. Memory, learning, and intelligence
- B. Attitude, subjective norms, and perceived behavioral control
- C. Emotion, personality, and motivation
- D. Reinforcement and punishment only

Correct Answer: B

Psychological Statement Q/A

1. Why do attitudes sometimes fail to predict behavior?

Answer: Attitudes may fail to predict behavior because factors such as social pressure, lack of accessibility, weak attitudes, and differences between general attitudes and specific behaviors can influence actions.

2. How does specificity affect the attitude-behavior relationship?

Answer: Specific attitudes are more likely to predict specific behaviors because they match the behavior being measured.

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3. How does self-awareness influence behavior?

Answer: Private self-awareness leads people to act according to personal attitudes, while public self-awareness leads them to follow social expectations.

4. What factors increase attitude strength?

Answer: Greater information, personal involvement, and direct experience increase attitude strength.

5. What are the three components of Theory of Planned Behavior?

Answer: The three components are attitude toward behavior, subjective norms, and perceived behavioral control.

Lesson 23: ATTITUDE CHANGE

Summarized Notes

Aims

To introduce the concept of attitude change.

Objectives

To describe motivational and external sources for changing attitudes.

To describe source variables that influence the effectiveness of persuasive messages.

Behaviour Changing Attitudes

According to self-perception theory (Bem, 1965), people can infer their attitudes by observing their own behaviors.

Behaviors can also change attitudes, especially when the behaviors are unexpected.

Cognitive Dissonance Theory (Festinger, 1957)

Cognitive dissonance is a feeling of discomfort caused by performing an action that is inconsistent with one's attitudes.

The principle of cognitive consistency was first introduced by Fritz Heider (1946).

Cognitive dissonance theory is a motivational approach based on Gestalt principles.

It suggests that humans prefer their thoughts and perceptions to be consistent and are motivated to maintain this consistency.

Festinger argued that people often engage in irrational or maladaptive behaviors and then rationalize those behaviors.

Festinger and Carlsmith Study (1959)

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Participants performed a boring task:

Emptying and filling trays.

Turning 48 wooden pegs.

After completing the task, participants were asked to tell the next participant that the task was enjoyable.

Participants were given either:

\$1 payment

\$20 payment

Later, participants were asked how interesting and enjoyable they actually found the task.

Findings

The results were opposite to what operant conditioning would predict.

According to operant conditioning, greater rewards should produce more favorable attitudes.

However, participants who received \$1 showed greater attitude change than those who received \$20.

The \$1 participants experienced greater cognitive dissonance because:

“The task was boring.”

“I told someone it was fun.”

The \$20 participants had sufficient justification for their behavior because the reward explained why they lied.

The \$1 participants lacked sufficient justification, so they changed their attitude to reduce discomfort.

They convinced themselves:

“The task was actually fun.”

People resolve cognitive inconsistency by either:

Adding a new explanation.

Changing their attitude.

Factors Affecting Dissonance

1. Justification

People reduce dissonance by finding explanations for their behavior.

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Example:

A doomsday cult group may reinterpret a failed prediction as a positive event to reduce dissonance.

2. Freedom of Choice

When people are forced to perform an action, they experience less dissonance because they can explain their behavior through external pressure.

3. Investment

Greater personal investment makes people more likely to maintain their beliefs.

Example:

People may continue supporting a political party despite evidence of incompetence or wrongdoing because they have invested time and effort in those beliefs.

Cognitive Dissonance and Persuasion

Cognitive dissonance changes attitudes through internal inconsistency.

Persuasion changes attitudes through an external message.

Persuasion is the process of intentionally attempting to change attitudes through communication.

Factors Influencing Persuasiveness of Messages

Three major factors influence persuasion:

Source: Who is communicating?

Message variables: What is the content?

Audience: To whom is the message delivered?

Source Factors

Source factors include:

Source credibility.

Source attractiveness.

Source Credibility

Credibility means the extent to which a communicator is believed and trusted.

Credibility includes:

Expertise.

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Trustworthiness.

Expertise

Bochner and Insko Study (1966)

Participants read statements claiming that less than 8 hours of sleep is required for effective functioning.

The statements were attributed either to:

An eminent psychologist.

A YMCA director.

Participants believed the statements more when they were told they came from an expert psychologist.

This showed that expertise increases persuasion.

Trustworthiness

Walster et al. Study (1966)

Participants read arguments about police authority and criminals' rights.

The arguments came from:

A convicted criminal.

A judge.

People found the criminal's arguments more impressive because individuals who argue for their own benefit are often considered less trustworthy.

People who argue against their personal interests are viewed as more credible.

Sleeper Effect

The sleeper effect refers to the delayed effectiveness of a persuasive message from a low-credibility source.

Hovland and Weiss Study (1951)

Participants read an article stating that nuclear submarines were safe.

The source was either:

Oppenheimer, a nuclear physicist.

Pravda, a Soviet newspaper.

Initially, the high-credibility source produced greater persuasion.

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After four weeks, the difference between high and low credibility sources disappeared.

Explanation of Sleeper Effect

Over time, people forget the source of information but remember the message content.

The connection between the message and source becomes weaker.

This causes:

Decrease in persuasion from high-credibility sources.

Increase in persuasion from low-credibility sources.

Kelman and Hovland (1953) replicated the study and removed the sleeper effect by reminding participants about the source before measuring attitudes.

Factors Promoting Sleeper Effect

According to Kumkale and Albarrachin (2004), three factors promote the sleeper effect:

The message itself must be convincing.

Credibility information should be presented after the message.

Information about the low-credibility source should decay faster than the message content.

Source Attractiveness

Attractive sources can increase persuasion.

Historical Example: Cigarette Advertising

During the 1920s, feminists were protesting against inequality.

Edward Bernays, nephew of Freud, used attractive and independent women in cigarette advertisements.

Smoking was presented as a symbol of freedom.

Many women adopted the “torch of freedom” image.

Cigarette company profits increased due to this new market.

Factors Indicating Attractiveness

Physical Appearance

Attractive individuals are often more persuasive.

Research showed attractive university students were more successful in persuading others to sign petitions.

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Attractive people are frequently used in advertisements.

Advertising often uses classical conditioning by associating attractive people with products.

This is called peripheral route persuasion.

Likeability

People are more easily persuaded by individuals they like.

Eagly and Chaiken (1993) found that simply saying positive things about others can increase likeability.

Similarity

Similarity between communicator and audience increases persuasion.

Important forms of similarity include:

Shared attitudes and values.

Similar backgrounds.

Similar appearance.

Simons et al. (1970) found that shared attitudes and values are especially important.

Important Exam Points

Self-perception theory explains that behaviors can influence attitudes.

Festinger (1957) proposed cognitive dissonance theory.

Cognitive dissonance is discomfort caused by inconsistent attitudes and behaviors.

Festinger and Carlsmith (1959) studied attitude change through insufficient justification.

\$1 participants showed greater attitude change because they experienced more dissonance.

Dissonance can be reduced through justification, freedom of choice, and investment.

Persuasion involves attitude change through external messages.

Source credibility includes expertise and trustworthiness.

Expert sources are more persuasive.

The sleeper effect occurs when low-credibility sources become more persuasive over time.

Attractiveness increases persuasion through physical appearance, likeability, and similarity.

Statement MCQs

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

1. Cognitive dissonance theory was proposed by:

- A. Bem
- B. Festinger
- C. Bandura
- D. Zajonc

Correct Answer: B

2. Cognitive dissonance refers to:

- A. Happiness after success
- B. Discomfort caused by inconsistent thoughts and actions
- C. Learning through rewards
- D. Memory failure

Correct Answer: B

3. Festinger and Carlsmith's study involved:

- A. Social learning
- B. Boring task and attitude change
- C. Personality testing
- D. Memory experiments

Correct Answer: B

4. The sleeper effect refers to:

- A. Immediate persuasion by experts
- B. Delayed influence of messages from low-credibility sources
- C. Forgetting all messages
- D. Lack of attitude change

Correct Answer: B

5. Source credibility includes:

- A. Intelligence and memory
- B. Expertise and trustworthiness
- C. Appearance and age only
- D. Personality and mood

Correct Answer: B

Psychological Statement Q/A

1. What is cognitive dissonance?

Answer: Cognitive dissonance is psychological discomfort caused by inconsistency between attitudes and behaviors.

2. Why did \$1 participants change their attitudes in Festinger and Carlsmith's study?

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Answer: They experienced greater dissonance because they had insufficient justification for lying, so they changed their attitudes to reduce discomfort.

3. What is persuasion?

Answer: Persuasion is the process of changing attitudes through communication or external messages.

4. What factors increase source credibility?

Answer: Expertise and trustworthiness increase source credibility and make messages more persuasive.

5. What is the sleeper effect?

Answer: The sleeper effect is the delayed increase in effectiveness of a persuasive message from a low-credibility source.

Lesson 24: ATTITUDE CHANGE (CONTINUED)

Summarized Notes

Aims

To introduce the concept of attitude change.

Objectives

To describe content (communication) and audience (target) variables that influence the effectiveness of persuasive messages.

To describe central and peripheral routes of persuasion and their effects on attitude strength.

Message Variables: What is the Content?

Message variables explain what makes a message persuasive independent of the source.

Important message factors include:

Facts versus vivid images.

Fear appeals.

Humor.

One-sided versus two-sided messages.

Repetition.

Facts vs. Vivid Images

Advertisers use both evidence-based and vivid graphic messages to influence people.

Evidence-Based Messages

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Evidence-based messages use facts and statistics to persuade.

Example:

“Last year 1100 students died with drug abuse.”

Evidence-based appeals are usually more persuasive, especially when information comes from a credible source.

Vividness-Based Appeals

Vivid messages use emotional and graphic images to influence people.

Example:

“Not everyone dies with drug use.”

Vivid images can increase persuasion by making information easier to remember.

Gonzales et al. (1988) found that combining evidence with vivid imagery increases persuasive power.

Sherman et al. (1990) suggested that vivid images activate relevant information in memory.

Limitations of Vivid Images

Vividness can sometimes reduce persuasion.

Frey and Eagly (1993) studied vivid and non-vivid messages among undergraduate students.

Participants were divided into:

High attention condition.

Low attention condition.

Results:

When participants paid close attention, vivid and non-vivid messages were equally effective.

When messages were presented incidentally, non-vivid messages were more persuasive.

Vivid elements can distract people from understanding the main message.

This distraction is greater when vivid information does not match the theme of the message (Smith & Shaffer, 2000).

Fear Appeal Persuasion

Fear is commonly used in advertising and communication to persuade people.

Examples:

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Anti-smoking advertisements warn about health consequences.

Insurance companies highlight risks to family and security.

Political messages may create fear about threats.

However, excessive fear can become harmful and reduce persuasion.

Protection Motivation Theory (Rogers et al., 1997)

Protection motivation theory explains that fear can motivate people to protect themselves.

Fear appeals are effective when four conditions are present:

The audience believes the danger is serious.

The audience believes the danger is likely to occur.

The audience believes the recommended action will reduce the danger.

The audience believes they are capable of performing the action.

Humor and Persuasion

Approximately 40% of advertisements use humor (Unger, 1996).

Public speakers also use humor to make messages more effective.

Effects of Humor

Humor increases attention.

People are more likely to listen to someone who makes them laugh.

Humorous communicators may become more likeable.

Humor must be related to the message to be effective.

Relevant humor → Central route processing.

Irrelevant humor → Peripheral route processing.

Smith et al. (1994) suggested that unrelated humor may distract people from the actual message.

One-Sided vs. Two-Sided Messages

One-Sided Messages

One-sided messages present only supporting arguments.

Two-Sided Messages

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Two-sided messages present both supporting and opposing arguments.

Hovland and Colleagues Study (1949)

Researchers studied how to convince American soldiers that the war against Japan would continue after Germany's surrender.

Both one-sided and two-sided messages were tested.

Results showed:

Two-sided messages increase credibility because they acknowledge opposing views.

Two-sided messages are especially effective when:

People initially disagree.

People are knowledgeable.

People may encounter opposing arguments later.

Acknowledging opposing views makes the communicator appear fair and objective.

Attitudinal Inoculation

Attitudinal inoculation refers to exposing people to weak opposing arguments to strengthen resistance against future persuasion.

McGuire (1999) suggested that protecting people from change should be balanced because people need to remain open to new information.

Repetition and Persuasion

Repetition can increase persuasion through the mere exposure effect.

Repeated exposure increases liking for neutral stimuli.

However, repetition can have opposite effects for stimuli that are initially negative (Cacioppo & Petty, 1989).

Too much repetition can reduce effectiveness.

Repetition with variation can prevent the wear-out effect (Pratkanis & Aronson, 1992).

Audience Variables

Audience variables influence how people respond to persuasive messages.

Important audience factors include:

Good mood.

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Involvement.

Individual differences.

Good Mood and Persuasion

Positive mood generally increases persuasion.

Research showed greater attitude change among people:

Eating in a snack shop (Janis et al., 1965).

Listening to pleasant music (Milliman, 1986).

Explanations

Classical Conditioning

Positive feelings become associated with the message.

Cognitive Response Approach

People in a positive mood process fewer arguments because they assume everything is fine.

Negative moods signal problems and encourage deeper thinking.

Happy people are more likely to use the peripheral route.

Unhappy people are more likely to use the central route.

Involvement

Involvement affects the route of persuasion.

There are two types:

Issue involvement.

Impression-relevant involvement.

Issue Involvement

Issue involvement occurs when the outcome of an argument has personal importance.

It leads to central route processing.

People focus on strong arguments and evidence.

Impression-Relevant Involvement

This occurs when people are concerned about how others will judge them.

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It leads to peripheral route processing.

People are influenced by attractive and socially approved communicators.

Attitudes connected with the self are more resistant to change.

Individual Differences

Need for Cognition (NFC)

Need for cognition refers to the degree to which individuals enjoy and engage in effortful thinking.

High NFC individuals:

Prefer thinking deeply.

Use the central route.

Have stronger and more stable attitudes.

Low NFC individuals:

Use mental shortcuts.

Prefer peripheral cues.

Have attitudes that are easier to change.

Age and Life Stage

Impressionable Years

Krosnick and Alwin (1989) suggested that young people are more open to persuasion because they experience social and political issues for the first time.

Life Stance Hypothesis (Visser & Krosnick, 1998)

Researchers studied attitude change among more than 8500 participants.

They examined attitudes toward:

International affairs.

Crime.

Race.

Results showed:

Young and elderly people show greater attitude change due to major life transitions.

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Middle-aged adults are more resistant to change.

Attitudes become stronger through information, knowledge, and involvement.

Knowledge and attitude strength increase during adulthood and decline after age 65.

Central and Peripheral Routes of Persuasion

Central Route

Central route involves careful examination of information and arguments.

Most likely when:

Message is personally relevant.

Need for cognition is high.

Mood is neutral.

Communicator speaks at a normal speed.

Effects:

Creates strong attitudes.

Attitudes resist counterarguments.

Attitudes better predict behavior.

Peripheral Route

Peripheral route involves relying on simple cues instead of detailed information.

Examples:

Attractiveness.

Popularity.

Message length.

Most likely when:

Message is not personally relevant.

Need for cognition is low.

Mood is positive.

Communicator speaks rapidly.

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Effects:

Creates weaker attitudes.

Attitudes are easily changed by counterarguments.

Attitudes do not strongly predict behavior.

Important Exam Points

Message variables influence persuasion independent of the communicator.

Evidence-based messages are generally more persuasive.

Vivid images can increase memory but may distract from the message.

Fear appeals are effective when people believe danger is serious, likely, and controllable.

Protection Motivation Theory explains fear-based persuasion.

Humor increases attention but must be relevant.

Two-sided messages increase credibility by acknowledging opposing views.

Attitudinal inoculation strengthens resistance against future persuasion.

Repetition increases liking through the mere exposure effect.

Positive moods increase susceptibility to peripheral persuasion.

Issue involvement leads to central processing.

Impression-relevant involvement leads to peripheral processing.

High need for cognition individuals prefer central processing.

Central route produces stronger and more lasting attitudes.

Peripheral route produces weaker and less stable attitudes.

Statement MCQs

1. Evidence-based messages are more persuasive when:

- A. They use humor only
- B. They come from credible sources
- C. They avoid facts
- D. They are repeated excessively

Correct Answer: B

2. Protection Motivation Theory explains:

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- A. Memory formation
- B. Fear-based persuasion
- C. Personality development
- D. Social learning

Correct Answer: B

3. Two-sided messages are effective because they:

- A. Ignore opposing views
- B. Present only positive information
- C. Acknowledge opposing arguments
- D. Reduce credibility

Correct Answer: C

4. Central route persuasion occurs when:

- A. People use simple cues
- B. People carefully evaluate information
- C. People ignore messages
- D. People rely on attractiveness

Correct Answer: B

5. Need for cognition refers to:

- A. Desire for social approval
- B. Preference for effortful thinking
- C. Fear of change
- D. Emotional reactions

Correct Answer: B

Psychological Statement Q/A

1. Why can vivid images sometimes reduce persuasion?

Answer: Vivid images can distract people from the main message and interfere with understanding when they do not match the message theme.

2. When are fear appeals effective?

Answer: Fear appeals are effective when people believe the danger is serious, likely, avoidable, and they feel capable of taking action.

3. Why are two-sided messages persuasive?

Answer: Two-sided messages increase credibility because they acknowledge opposing arguments and make the communicator appear fair.

4. What is the difference between central and peripheral routes?

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Answer: Central route involves careful evaluation of arguments, while peripheral route depends on simple cues such as attractiveness or popularity.

5. How does need for cognition affect persuasion?

Answer: People with high need for cognition prefer detailed information and use the central route, while people with low need for cognition rely on peripheral cues.

Lesson 25: PREJUDICE AND DISCRIMINATION

Summarized Notes

Activities on Attitude Change

Activity on Cognitive Dissonance

- Cognitive dissonance activity helps understand how inconsistency between attitudes and behaviors creates discomfort.
- Participants rate their agreement with the statement:
“Illiteracy is a serious problem that requires attention.”
- Participants are asked whether they have personally done anything to reduce illiteracy.
- This activity demonstrates the experience of cognitive dissonance.

Applied Social Psychology Lab

Practical Application of Attitude and Behavior Change

- Public relation firms create specific images to influence public attitudes.
- Education can sometimes be used as hidden propaganda for establishing certain beliefs.
- Attitude change can occur through successive approximation, especially for changing strongly held views.

Prejudice and Discrimination

Aims

- To introduce psychological factors that influence and drive prejudice and discrimination.

Objectives

- To compare and contrast different theories of prejudice and discrimination.
- To evaluate cognitive and motivational components of inter-group bias.

Inter-group Intolerance

- The words “we” and “they” represent social and psychological distance between groups.

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- People associated with “they” are often viewed as different, dangerous, disrespectful, or unwanted.
- Groups labeled as “they” are usually valued less compared to groups associated with “we” and “us.”
- Inter-group intolerance explains how people develop negative attitudes toward other groups.

Prejudice and Discrimination

Prejudice

- Prejudice is a negative attitude toward members of specific social groups.
- It is a specific form of negative feeling toward a group.

Discrimination

- Discrimination is negative behavior directed toward members of groups who are the target of prejudice.

Stereotypes

- Stereotypes are beliefs about personal attributes shared by people belonging to a particular group or social category.

Factors Shaping Prejudice and Discrimination

1. Cognitive Sources

- Categorization of people into different groups.

2. Emotional Sources

- Scapegoat theory explains prejudice through displaced frustration and aggression.
- Authoritarian personality theory explains prejudice through personality characteristics.

3. Social Sources

- Social inequalities, unequal status, religion, and stereotype threat contribute to prejudice.
- Social identity and inter-group competition influence group bias.

Cognitive Sources of Prejudice

Categorization

- People simplify their environment by organizing objects and individuals into categories.
- Categorization helps people understand the social world quickly.
- Once categorized, people begin to perceive individuals differently.

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- Ethnicity, gender, religion, and social background are common bases of categorization.
- Categorization itself is not prejudice but provides a foundation for developing prejudice.
- Social identity theory suggests that people with strong social identities are more likely to divide others into “us” and “them.”

Out-group Homogeneity Effect

- Out-group homogeneity effect is the perception that members of another group are more similar to each other than members of one's own group.
- People believe:
“They are all alike, while we are diverse.”
- This perception creates stereotypes about personalities, abilities, and motives of other groups.
- Stereotypes prevent recognition of individual differences.

Function of Stereotyped Thinking

Quickness

- Stereotypes provide quick information about unfamiliar people.
- They act as mental shortcuts during uncertain situations.
- They reduce the need to spend time learning about each individual.
- Stereotyped thinking can also produce incorrect judgments and faulty conclusions.

Cognitive Efficiency

- Stereotypes save mental resources for other tasks.
- People may ignore information that conflicts with existing stereotypes.

Stereotypes Against Alien Cultures

Cultural Stereotypes

- Research by Burr (2002) explored how cultural stereotypes influence perceptions of mental health professionals in the UK.
- Some professionals believed South Asian women experience psychological problems because of cultural restrictions.
- Such views often ignore positive aspects and strengths of different cultures.

Cultural Conflicts

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- Some stereotypes suggest that people from other cultures must adopt Western values to resolve conflicts.

- These beliefs may create assumptions about cultural superiority.

Arranged Marriage Stereotypes

- Some people believe arranged marriages are automatically harmful.

- Such assumptions may ignore cultural meanings and supportive aspects of arranged marriage systems.

Expectations and Awareness

- Stereotypes can lead people to underestimate the strengths and coping abilities of other cultures.

- Cultural practices may provide protection against stress and difficulties.

Emotional Sources of Prejudice

Frustration and Aggression: Scapegoat Theory

- Scapegoat theory explains prejudice as displaced aggression toward a weaker group.

- When the real cause of frustration is unknown or difficult to attack, people direct anger toward another group.

- Historical examples show groups becoming targets during economic and social crises.

- Economic frustration has often increased hostility toward minority groups.

Realistic Group Conflict Theory

- Competition between groups can create prejudice.

- The success of one group may be viewed as a threat to another group.

- Conflict occurs when groups compete for limited resources and goals.

Prejudice as a Personality Type

Authoritarian Personality Theory

- Adorno and Frenkel-Brunswick studied the psychological causes behind Nazi Germany's extreme prejudice.

- They identified authoritarian personality as a tendency linked with inter-group hostility.

Characteristics of Authoritarian Personality

- Strong obedience and submission to authority.

- Strict acceptance of cultural rules and values.

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- Belief that morality consists of clear right and wrong choices.
- Intolerance toward weak or different groups.

The F Scale

- Adorno, Frenkel-Brunswick, Levinson, and Stanford (1950) developed the F (Fascist) Scale.
- The scale measured authoritarian personality characteristics.
- Early explanations linked authoritarian personality with childhood conflicts and harsh parenting.

Social Learning Theory

- Altemeyer (1981, 1988) suggested that authoritarian tendencies develop through learning.
- Adolescents may develop prejudicial attitudes by observing authoritarian individuals.
- Modeling and reinforcement influence the development of prejudice.
- Research supports the idea that prejudicial thinking can be learned socially.

Important Exam Points

- Prejudice is a negative attitude toward members of a social group.
- Discrimination is negative behavior toward members of a group.
- Stereotypes are beliefs about characteristics of social groups.
- Categorization provides the foundation for prejudice.
- Out-group homogeneity effect means seeing other groups as more similar than they actually are.
- Stereotypes provide quick judgments but may produce errors.
- Scapegoat theory explains prejudice as displaced aggression.
- Realistic group conflict theory explains prejudice through competition between groups.
- Authoritarian personality is characterized by obedience to authority and intolerance toward weaker groups.
- The F Scale was developed by Adorno and colleagues to measure authoritarian personality.
- Social learning theory suggests prejudice develops through observation and reinforcement.
- Social identity theory explains how people divide others into “us” and “them.”

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Statement MCQs

1. Prejudice refers to:

- A. Positive behavior toward groups
- B. Negative attitude toward members of a group
- C. Equal treatment of all groups
- D. Individual personality traits

Correct Answer: B

2. Discrimination is:

- A. A belief about a group
- B. A social category
- C. Negative behavior toward a group
- D. A personal attitude only

Correct Answer: C

3. Stereotypes are:

- A. Accurate information about every individual
- B. Beliefs about characteristics of groups
- C. Emotional reactions only
- D. Social relationships

Correct Answer: B

4. Scapegoat theory explains prejudice as:

- A. Logical decision making
- B. Displaced aggression toward groups
- C. Positive group identity
- D. Social cooperation

Correct Answer: B

5. Authoritarian personality is associated with:

- A. Acceptance of all differences
- B. Intolerance and submission to authority
- C. Lack of social identity
- D. Absence of stereotypes

Correct Answer: B

Psychological Statement Q/A

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

1. What is the difference between prejudice and discrimination?

Answer: Prejudice is a negative attitude toward a group, whereas discrimination is negative behavior directed toward that group.

2. How does categorization contribute to prejudice?

Answer: Categorization divides people into groups and may encourage stereotypes and biased judgments.

3. What is the out-group homogeneity effect?

Answer: It is the tendency to view members of another group as more similar to each other than members of one's own group.

4. How does scapegoat theory explain prejudice?

Answer: It explains that people may direct frustration and aggression toward weaker groups when the actual cause of frustration is difficult to identify.

5. How does social learning theory explain prejudice?

Answer: Social learning theory suggests that prejudicial attitudes are learned through observation, modeling, and reinforcement.

Lesson 26: PREJUDICE AND DISCRIMINATION (CONTINUE.....)

Summarized Notes

Social Inequalities: Unequal Status

- Social conditions can influence the development and maintenance of prejudice.
- Prejudice serves different functions such as gaining social acceptance, reducing anxiety, increasing pleasure, and protecting self-esteem.
- Prejudice has historically been stronger in regions where slavery existed.
- During the nineteenth century, European writers and politicians justified imperialism by describing colonized people as inferior and in need of protection.

Social Inequalities: Religion

- All major religions promote equality, justice, and respect for others.
- Islam strongly emphasizes human rights, the rights of neighbors, and equality among all people.
- During the Farewell Sermon (Hajjat-ul-Wida), Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) declared that no person is superior because of race or color.
- Some studies found that strong religious beliefs may still be associated with prejudice.
- People who appear religious in questionnaires may still display prejudice in their actual behavior.
- True religious values encourage love and tolerance rather than hatred.

Social Inequalities: Stereotype Threat

- Stereotype threat is the fear of being judged according to a negative stereotype.
- This fear can reduce a person's actual performance.
- Spencer and Quinn (1999) showed that women's math performance decreased when they were told

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men usually perform better.

- When participants were told there was no gender difference, women's performance improved.
- Stereotype threat affects both men and women depending on the situation.

Stereotype Threat and Self-Fulfilling Prophecy

- Stereotype threat is an immediate psychological reaction to negative expectations.
- Self-fulfilling prophecy occurs when stereotypes gradually become part of a person's self-concept.
- Steele and Aronson (1995) found that Black participants performed worse on difficult verbal tests because of negative racial stereotypes.
- Stone et al. (1999) found that Black participants performed better when a golf task was described as testing natural athletic ability rather than sports intelligence.
- Expectations created by stereotypes can influence actual performance.

Social Sources: Social Identity

- Human beings naturally belong to different social groups.
- Social identity includes roles such as nationality, profession, gender, and religion.
- Self-concept consists of both personal identity and social identity.
- An in-group member belongs to the same social group as the individual.
- An out-group member belongs to a different social group.
- Simply dividing people into groups changes how they evaluate each other.
- In-group bias is the tendency to favor members of one's own group.
- Racism and sexism are common examples of group-based prejudice.

Social Identity: Self-Concept

Minimal Group Paradigm (Tajfel et al., 1971)

- Participants were randomly assigned to different groups.
- Members did not know each other before the experiment.
- Participants distributed rewards using code numbers.
- They consistently gave more rewards to members of their own group.
- Mere categorization was enough to create in-group favoritism.
- This effect occurred without historical, cultural, or religious differences.

Billig and Tajfel's Study (1973)

- Researchers compared grouping by similarity and random assignment.
- Even completely random group membership produced in-group bias.
- Participants preferred rewarding members of their own group.
- The findings supported the idea that simple categorization creates prejudice.

Social Identity Theory

- Tajfel and Turner (1979) proposed Social Identity Theory.
- People's self-esteem is partly based on the status of their social groups.
- Individuals prefer groups that make them feel positive about themselves.
- When their group's status is threatened, people show stronger in-group bias.

Intergroup Competition: Realistic Group Conflict Theory

- Competition for limited resources creates conflict between groups.
- Conflict increases hostility toward the out-group.

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- Conflict also strengthens loyalty toward the in-group.
- Competition encourages prejudice and ethnocentrism.

Sherif's Robbers Cave Experiment (1955)

Phase I: Creating In-Groups

- Twenty boys aged 11–12 attended a summer camp.
- They were divided into two groups called the Rattlers and the Eagles.
- Group activities helped develop strong group identity.
- Members began distinguishing between "us" and "them."

Phase II: Intergroup Competition

- The two groups competed in athletic contests for valuable prizes.
- Competition quickly created hostility between the groups.
- The Eagles burned the Rattlers' flag.
- The Rattlers damaged the Eagles' camp.
- Verbal insults changed into physical aggression.
- Loyalty within each group increased.

Phase III: Reducing Hostility

- Simply bringing the groups together did not reduce conflict.
- Researchers introduced superordinate goals that required cooperation.
- Both groups worked together to solve shared problems, such as pushing a broken bus.
- Cooperation reduced prejudice and improved relationships between the groups.
- Recent research shows that even the perception of competition can increase prejudice.

Important Exam Points

- Prejudice is influenced by unequal social status and social inequalities.
- Religions generally promote equality and discourage prejudice.
- Stereotype threat is the fear of confirming a negative stereotype.
- Self-fulfilling prophecy occurs when stereotypes influence actual behavior.
- Social identity consists of both personal identity and group identity.
- In-group bias is the tendency to favor one's own group over others.
- The Minimal Group Paradigm showed that simple categorization creates group bias.
- Tajfel and Turner developed Social Identity Theory.
- Realistic Group Conflict Theory explains prejudice through competition for limited resources.
- Sherif's Robbers Cave Experiment demonstrated that competition increases prejudice, while cooperation through superordinate goals reduces conflict.

Statement MCQs

1. Stereotype threat refers to:

- A. Positive expectations about a group
- B. Fear of being judged by a negative stereotype
- C. Equal treatment of all groups

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D. Group cooperation

Correct Answer: B

2. In-group bias is the tendency to:

- A. Treat everyone equally
- B. Favor members of one's own group
- C. Ignore group membership
- D. Dislike all social groups

Correct Answer: B

3. The Minimal Group Paradigm demonstrated that:

- A. Religion creates prejudice
- B. Competition is always necessary for prejudice
- C. Mere categorization can produce group bias
- D. Intelligence determines prejudice

Correct Answer: C

4. Realistic Group Conflict Theory explains prejudice through:

- A. Childhood experiences only
- B. Competition for limited resources
- C. Personality traits alone
- D. Genetic inheritance

Correct Answer: B

5. Sherif's Robbers Cave Experiment showed that prejudice can be reduced through:

- A. Isolation between groups
- B. Punishment only
- C. Superordinate goals requiring cooperation
- D. Ignoring the conflict

Correct Answer: C

Psychological Statement Q/A

1. What is stereotype threat?

Answer: Stereotype threat is the fear that a person will be judged according to a negative stereotype, which may reduce performance.

2. What is in-group bias?

Answer: In-group bias is the tendency to evaluate and reward members of one's own group more favorably than members of other groups.

3. What did the Minimal Group Paradigm demonstrate?

Answer: It demonstrated that simply placing people into different groups is enough to create in-group favoritism and intergroup bias.

4. What does Social Identity Theory explain?

Answer: Social Identity Theory explains that people enhance their self-esteem by identifying with social groups and viewing their own group more positively than others.

5. How did Sherif's Robbers Cave Experiment reduce prejudice?

Answer: The experiment reduced prejudice by giving both groups superordinate goals that required cooperation, which improved relationships and decreased hostility.

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Lesson 27: REDUCING PREJUDICE AND DISCRIMINATION

Summarized Notes

Reducing Prejudice and Discrimination

Reduction of prejudice and discrimination mainly depends on two approaches:

- Contact hypothesis (Group-based approach)
- Re-categorization (Individual-based approach)

Contact Hypothesis

- Contact between members of different social groups can reduce prejudice under appropriate conditions.
- The Contact Hypothesis was proposed by Allport (1954).
- Wright et al. (1997) found that friendship between members of competing groups reduced intergroup bias.
- Participants became more willing to share rewards fairly after developing friendships.

Conditions Necessary for Contact to Reduce Prejudice

- Mere contact is not enough to reduce prejudice.
- Contact should be pleasant, cooperative, and long-lasting.
- Four important conditions must be present:
 - Social norms favor equality.
 - Sustained close contact.
 - Equal social status.
 - Cooperative interaction.

Social Norms

- Government, schools, laws, and community leaders should promote equality.
- Positive messages from political and religious leaders encourage acceptance of different groups.
- Discrimination decreases when organizations do not tolerate prejudice.
- Psychology encourages respectful language instead of stigmatizing labels.
- Cognitive dissonance supports attitude change when behavior and attitudes are inconsistent.

Cognitive Dissonance (Festinger, 1957)

- Cognitive dissonance occurs when attitudes and behavior do not match.
- This creates psychological discomfort.
- People try to reduce discomfort by changing their attitudes.
- Laws discouraging discrimination can gradually change people's attitudes.

Sustained Close Contact

- Long-term friendships reduce both obvious and subtle prejudice.
- Contact should be frequent, meaningful, and close enough for people to know each other well.
- Children should work and interact together instead of remaining separated.
- Cook (1978) called this "acquaintance potential."
- Positive experiences with one member often improve attitudes toward the entire group.
- Stephan and Rosenfield (1978) found improved attitudes of White Americans toward Mexican Americans after quality contact.
- Team sports and the Jigsaw Puzzle technique encourage cooperation and reduce prejudice.

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- Stephan and Stephan (1984) found that increased contact improved knowledge and positive attitudes toward out-groups.

Equal Social Status

- Contact is most effective when groups have equal status.
- Unequal status may strengthen stereotypes and prejudice.
- Minority members should not interact in subordinate roles.
- Teachers and supervisors should create equal opportunities for everyone.

Intergroup Cooperation

- Cooperation reduces prejudice more effectively than competition.
- Sherif's Robbers Cave Experiment showed that shared goals reduced hostility.
- Superordinate goals require different groups to work together.
- Blanchard et al. (1975) found cooperation works best when groups successfully achieve common goals.

Weigel et al. (1975) Study

- Researchers compared cooperative and traditional teaching methods.
- Students from different racial backgrounds worked together in mixed groups.
- Cooperative learning reduced prejudice and improved relationships.
- Studies conclude that contact is effective only when it includes equal status, cooperation, and shared goals.

Problems with the Contact Hypothesis

- Minority members may fear being judged negatively.
- Majority members may avoid interaction due to anxiety.
- Poor communication may increase misunderstandings.
- Positive contact with one person may not change attitudes toward the whole group.
- The Contact Hypothesis requires many conditions, making it difficult to apply in real life.

Re-Categorization

Re-categorization changes how people think about group membership.

Combination

- Separate groups are combined into one larger group.
- Inter-marriage between different groups can reduce prejudice.
- Combining groups encourages people to see themselves as one community.

Subtypes and Individual Uniqueness

- Large groups are divided into smaller categories.
- Each individual is viewed as unique instead of being judged by group stereotypes.
- This reduces stereotyping and prejudice.

Common In-group Identity Model (Gaertner et al., 1993)

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- People replace the "us versus them" view with a single shared identity.
- Members begin to think of themselves as one group.
- This reduces intergroup bias.

Gaertner et al. (1989) Study

- Participants were divided into two minimal groups.
- Some participants worked as one combined group, while others remained separate.
- Both combination and individual uniqueness reduced in-group bias.
- The one-group approach produced the greatest improvement in attitudes toward former out-group members.

Applied Social Psychology Lab

Practical Application of Reducing Prejudice

- Programs should encourage equal-status and cooperative interaction between different groups.
- Schools and workplaces should promote a common group identity.
- Media and governments should support equality and discourage discrimination.
- Shared goals help reduce prejudice and improve social harmony.

Important Exam Points

- The Contact Hypothesis was proposed by Allport (1954).
- Contact reduces prejudice only under specific conditions.
- Four conditions are social norms, sustained contact, equal status, and cooperation.
- Cognitive dissonance explains attitude change when behavior and beliefs conflict.
- Sustained close contact promotes friendship and reduces prejudice.
- Equal social status is necessary for successful intergroup contact.
- Superordinate goals reduce hostility between competing groups.
- Cooperative learning is more effective than traditional competitive learning.
- Re-categorization reduces prejudice by changing group perceptions.
- The Common In-group Identity Model changes "us vs. them" into one shared group.
- Gaertner et al. found that both combination and individual uniqueness reduce in-group bias.

Statement MCQs

1. The Contact Hypothesis was proposed by:

- A. Festinger
- B. Allport
- C. Tajfel
- D. Sherif

Correct Answer: B

2. Which condition is necessary for contact to reduce prejudice?

- A. Competition
- B. Equal social status
- C. Isolation
- D. Segregation

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Correct Answer: B

3. Cognitive dissonance occurs when:

- A. People belong to two groups
- B. Attitudes and behavior are inconsistent
- C. People cooperate successfully
- D. Groups compete for resources

Correct Answer: B

4. The Common In-group Identity Model reduces prejudice by:

- A. Increasing competition
- B. Creating separate identities
- C. Promoting one shared group identity
- D. Encouraging stereotypes

Correct Answer: C

5. Superordinate goals help reduce prejudice because they:

- A. Increase competition
- B. Require cooperation between groups
- C. Strengthen stereotypes
- D. Separate different groups

Correct Answer: B

Psychological Statement Q/A

1. What is the Contact Hypothesis?

Answer: The Contact Hypothesis states that meaningful contact between members of different social groups can reduce prejudice when appropriate conditions are present.

2. What are the four conditions required for effective intergroup contact?

Answer: The four conditions are supportive social norms, sustained close contact, equal social status, and cooperative interaction.

3. What is cognitive dissonance?

Answer: Cognitive dissonance is the psychological discomfort experienced when a person's attitudes and behavior are inconsistent, leading them to change their attitudes.

4. What is re-categorization?

Answer: Re-categorization is a technique that reduces prejudice by changing how people classify themselves and others into social groups.

5. How do superordinate goals reduce prejudice?

Answer: Superordinate goals require different groups to cooperate toward a common objective, which reduces hostility and improves intergroup relationships.

Lesson 28: INTERPERSONAL ATTRACTION

Summarized Notes

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Interpersonal Attraction

Aims

- To introduce the concept of interpersonal attraction and related concepts.

Objectives

- To explain interpersonal attraction.
- To discuss the reasons for affiliation.
- To describe factors influencing affiliation desires.
- To explain situational factors that attract people toward others.

What is Interpersonal Attraction?

Definition

- Interpersonal attraction is the desire to approach another person.
- Attraction is influenced by personal qualities, social situations, and physical appearance.
- People may approach or avoid others depending on these characteristics.

Affiliation Needs

- People spend most of their time with others.
- Individuals desire close relationships with people who care about them.
- Affiliation satisfies emotional and social needs.

Reasons for Affiliation

Two major theories explain why people seek relationships:

Social Comparison Theory

- Proposed by Festinger (1954).
- People evaluate their thoughts, feelings, and behaviors by comparing themselves with others.
- Social comparison helps individuals understand themselves.
- Comparison is strongest when people feel uncertain.
- People usually compare themselves with similar individuals.
- Social comparison also influences emotions and friendship choices.

Social Exchange Theory

- Focuses on interactions between people.
- Relationships continue when rewards are greater than costs.
- Rewards may be material (money, food) or non-material (love, affection, information).
- George Homans (1958) described relationships as social exchanges.
- Thibaut and Kelly explained that alternative relationships also influence whether people remain in a relationship.
- Some individuals remain in unsatisfying relationships because they perceive no better alternatives.

Factors Influencing Affiliation Desires

Evolutionary Heritage

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- The need to belong is a basic human motivation.
- Evolutionary psychologists believe the desire for friendship is inherited.
- People differ in their level of social interaction.
- Strong social relationships reduce stress and anxiety.
- Rejection produces emotional pain similar to physical pain.
- The anterior cingulate region of the brain is involved in social pain.

Brain and Central Nervous System (CNS) Activity

CNS Arousability

- CNS arousability is the level at which stimulation activates the nervous system.
- Introverts have higher levels of CNS arousal.
- Introverts avoid excessive social interaction to prevent overstimulation.
- Extroverts prefer active and noisy environments.
- Extroverts often perform better in stimulating situations.

Brain Activity

- Extroverts experience greater activation of dopamine reward pathways.
- Positive experiences activate emotional brain areas such as the frontal lobe and amygdala.
- Biological differences influence people's desire for social interaction.

Culture, Gender, and Affiliation

- Culture influences affiliation needs.
- People in individualistic cultures develop more social relationships independently.
- These relationships are often numerous but less intimate.
- Hofstede (1980) found a positive relationship between individualism and affiliation needs.
- Women define themselves more through close relationships.
- Women are generally more relationship-oriented and remember important social events more accurately.

Characteristics of the Situation and Attraction

Three important situational factors influence attraction:

- Proximity
- Familiarity
- Anxiety

Close Proximity Fosters Liking

- People living near each other are more likely to become friends.
- Bossard (1932) found that couples often married people living nearby.
- Festinger, Schachter, and Back (1950) found that graduate students formed friendships with neighbors living on the same floor or in the same building.
- Ebbesen et al. (1976) found that people living nearby could become both close friends and enemies.

Why Does Proximity Increase Attraction?

- People are easier to meet and interact with.
- Less time, effort, and money are required.
- Frequent interaction increases liking.
- Expecting future interaction also increases attraction.

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Familiarity Breeds Liking

- Familiarity increases attraction through repeated exposure.
- Zajonc (1968) proposed the Mere Exposure Hypothesis.
- The more often people see someone, the more they tend to like them.
- Repeated exposure creates comfort and reduces fear of unfamiliar people.
- Grush et al. (1978) found that greater media exposure increased political candidates' popularity.

Does Anxiety Increase Affiliation?

Schachter's Study (1959)

- Female participants were told they would receive painful or painless electric shocks.
- Participants chose whether to wait alone or with others.
- Highly anxious participants preferred waiting with others.
- Even when conversation was not allowed, anxious individuals still preferred company.
- Others helped reduce anxiety through emotional comparison and social support.

Important Exam Points

- Interpersonal attraction is the desire to approach another person.
- Social Comparison Theory was proposed by Festinger (1954).
- Social Exchange Theory explains relationships through rewards and costs.
- The need to belong is an inherited human motivation.
- Social rejection activates the anterior cingulate, similar to physical pain.
- Introverts have higher CNS arousal, while extroverts seek greater stimulation.
- Culture and gender influence affiliation needs.
- Proximity is one of the strongest predictors of friendship.
- Zajonc proposed the Mere Exposure Hypothesis.
- Familiarity generally increases liking.
- Schachter (1959) found that anxious people prefer to wait with others.

Statement MCQs

1. Interpersonal attraction refers to:

- A. Avoiding social relationships
- B. Desire to approach another person
- C. Competing with others
- D. Group discrimination

Correct Answer: B

2. Social Comparison Theory was proposed by:

- A. Homans
- B. Schachter
- C. Festinger
- D. Hofstede

Correct Answer: C

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3. According to Social Exchange Theory, relationships continue when:

- A. Costs exceed rewards
- B. Rewards exceed costs
- C. People are physically attractive
- D. Individuals avoid comparison

Correct Answer: B

4. Zajonc's Mere Exposure Hypothesis states that:

- A. Distance increases attraction
- B. Repeated exposure increases liking
- C. Competition increases friendship
- D. Anxiety reduces attraction

Correct Answer: B

5. Schachter's study found that highly anxious individuals preferred to:

- A. Remain alone
- B. Avoid social contact
- C. Wait with other people
- D. Leave the experiment

Correct Answer: C

Psychological Statement Q/A

1. What is interpersonal attraction?

Answer: Interpersonal attraction is the desire to approach another person and develop a social relationship.

2. What does Social Comparison Theory explain?

Answer: It explains that people evaluate their thoughts, feelings, and behaviors by comparing themselves with others, especially similar individuals.

3. What is the main idea of Social Exchange Theory?

Answer: Social Exchange Theory states that people maintain relationships when the rewards are greater than the costs.

4. What is the Mere Exposure Hypothesis?

Answer: The Mere Exposure Hypothesis states that repeated exposure to a person or object increases liking and attraction.

5. What did Schachter's anxiety experiment demonstrate?

Answer: The study demonstrated that people experiencing high anxiety prefer to be with others because social presence reduces uncertainty and emotional stress.

Lesson 29: INTERPERSONAL ATTRACTION (CONTINUE.....)

Summarized Notes

Aims

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

- To introduce the concept of interpersonal attraction and related concepts.

Objectives

- To describe the characteristics of others that influence interpersonal attraction.
- To discuss situations in which social interaction becomes problematic.

Characteristics of Others and Attraction

Three important characteristics influence interpersonal attraction:

- Physical attractiveness
- Similarity
- Desirable personal attributes

Physical Attractiveness

- Physical attractiveness strongly influences first impressions.
- People often assume that attractive individuals possess positive personality traits.
- This belief is known as the "**What is Beautiful is Good**" stereotype.

Research on Physical Attractiveness Stereotype

- Berscheid and Walster (1972) found that attractive people were judged as having more desirable personalities.
- Attractive individuals were believed to be happier, sociable, successful, intelligent, and mentally healthy.
- Hollywood movies often portray attractive characters as successful and virtuous.
- Meta-analyses by Eagly et al. (1991) and Feingold (1992) supported the attractiveness stereotype.

Cross-Cultural Differences

- The attractiveness stereotype exists in both individualistic and collectivist cultures.
- Although standards differ across cultures, physical attractiveness generally creates positive impressions.

Research with Children

- Attractive infants are viewed as more likable, competent, and easier to care for.
- Adults form positive impressions of attractive children.

Attractiveness and Job-Related Outcomes

- Physical attractiveness influences hiring, promotions, and salary decisions.
- Frieze et al. (1991) found that attractive employees generally earned higher salaries.
- Attractive women received higher salaries later in their careers.
- Attractive men also earned more than less attractive men.
- Physical appearance can influence career success.

Obesity and Attractiveness Bias

- Obese individuals often experience prejudice and workplace discrimination.
- Many people incorrectly believe obesity reflects personal responsibility.
- Anti-fat prejudice is stronger in individualistic cultures.

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Who is Attractive?

People generally consider the following features attractive:

- Average facial features.
- Symmetrical faces.
- Healthy physical appearance.
- Men generally prefer women with lower waist-to-hip ratios because they signal youth and fertility.
- In food-scarce environments, higher waist-to-hip ratios may be preferred.
- Female attractiveness is associated with youthful facial features.
- Male attractiveness is associated with mature facial features such as broad jaws and thick eyebrows.

Why Does Attractiveness Matter?

- Attractive people are believed to possess many positive qualities.
- Being associated with attractive individuals improves others' impressions.
- Evolutionary psychologists believe attractiveness signals health and reproductive fitness.

Is the Attractiveness Stereotype Accurate?

- Feingold (1992) found no significant relationship between physical attractiveness and traits such as intelligence, self-esteem, dominance, or mental health.
- Attractive people are not necessarily better in personality or ability.

Similarity

- People are generally attracted to others who are similar to themselves.
- Similarity increases friendship and relationship satisfaction.

Demographic Similarity

- Friendships often develop between people of similar age, gender, race, and educational background.
- Shared demographic characteristics increase attraction.

Attitudinal Similarity

- Newcomb's Boarding House Study found that similar attitudes increase mutual liking.
- Byrne and Nelson (1965) showed that people liked others who shared similar opinions.
- The proportion of shared attitudes is more important than the total number of similarities.
- Greater attitude similarity produces stronger interpersonal attraction.

Similarity in Physical Attractiveness

- Romantic partners are often similar in physical attractiveness.
- This idea is known as the **Matching Hypothesis**.
- People expect relationships to be more successful when partners have similar levels of attractiveness.

Desirable Personal Attributes

Warmth

- Warm people express kindness, praise, and approval.
- Smiling, attentiveness, and emotional expression increase perceptions of warmth.
- Warm individuals are generally more attractive as friends and partners.

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Competence

- People like individuals who are intelligent, skilled, and capable.
- Different relationships require different forms of competence.
- Extremely perfect individuals may sometimes be viewed as less approachable.

When Social Interaction Becomes Problematic

Social Anxiety

- Social anxiety is the fear of being negatively evaluated by others.
- It often causes people to avoid social situations.
- Highly anxious individuals are more sensitive to rejection.
- Social anxiety may cause nervous behavior that creates negative impressions.
- This can become a self-fulfilling prophecy.

Loneliness

- Loneliness is having fewer or less satisfying relationships than desired.
- It results from unmet social and emotional needs.

Age, Gender, Culture, and Loneliness

- Adolescents and young adults experience the highest levels of loneliness.
- Social transitions such as leaving home or beginning careers contribute to loneliness.
- Loneliness generally decreases during adulthood.
- Older adults may become lonely because of poor health or loss of loved ones.
- Women often experience loneliness when emotional intimacy is lacking.
- Men often experience loneliness when group interaction decreases.

Social Skills Deficits and Loneliness

- Chronically lonely people often expect negative social outcomes.
- They perceive themselves as less friendly and less likable.
- They believe improving their social relationships is beyond their control.
- These negative beliefs make forming new relationships more difficult.

Important Exam Points

- Physical attractiveness creates positive first impressions.
- The "What is Beautiful is Good" stereotype assumes attractive people possess desirable qualities.
- Attractive individuals often receive advantages in employment and promotions.
- Average and symmetrical faces are generally considered attractive.
- Feingold found no relationship between attractiveness and personality traits.
- Similarity increases attraction and friendship.
- Byrne and Nelson demonstrated that attitude similarity increases liking.
- The Matching Hypothesis states that people prefer partners with similar levels of attractiveness.
- Warmth and competence are desirable personal attributes.
- Social anxiety is fear of negative evaluation.
- Loneliness results from unsatisfying social relationships.
- Young adults experience higher levels of loneliness than most other age groups.

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Statement MCQs

1. The belief that attractive people possess positive personality traits is called:

- A. Matching hypothesis
- B. Social comparison
- C. What is Beautiful is Good stereotype
- D. Social exchange theory

Correct Answer: C

2. Byrne and Nelson found that attraction increases with:

- A. Physical distance
- B. Attitude similarity
- C. Competition
- D. Age differences

Correct Answer: B

3. The Matching Hypothesis suggests that:

- A. Opposites attract each other
- B. People prefer partners with similar physical attractiveness
- C. Intelligence determines attraction
- D. Wealth determines relationships

Correct Answer: B

4. Social anxiety is primarily the fear of:

- A. Physical injury
- B. Being negatively evaluated by others
- C. Public speaking only
- D. Working in groups

Correct Answer: B

5. Loneliness is defined as:

- A. Living alone
- B. Having no friends
- C. Having fewer or less satisfying relationships than desired
- D. Avoiding all social interaction

Correct Answer: C

Psychological Statement Q/A

1. What is the "What is Beautiful is Good" stereotype?

Answer: It is the belief that physically attractive people possess more positive personality traits and abilities than unattractive people.

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2. What is the Matching Hypothesis?

Answer: The Matching Hypothesis states that people are generally attracted to romantic partners who have similar levels of physical attractiveness.

3. How does attitude similarity influence attraction?

Answer: People tend to like others who share similar attitudes, beliefs, and opinions because similarity promotes understanding and compatibility.

4. What is social anxiety?

Answer: Social anxiety is the unpleasant fear of being negatively judged or evaluated by other people, leading individuals to avoid social situations.

5. What is loneliness?

Answer: Loneliness is the feeling that one's social or intimate relationships are fewer or less satisfying than desired, resulting in emotional distress.

Lesson 30: INTIMATE RELATIONSHIPS

Summarized Notes

Aims

- To introduce the concept of intimate relationships, attachment styles, and adult relationships.

Objectives

- To explain intimacy.
- To describe how important others become part of one's self-concept.
- To discuss attachment as an adaptive response.
- To explain the relationship between attachment styles and adult relationships.
- To discuss attachment styles in romantic relationships and friendships.

Applied Social Psychology Lab

Developing Social Skills

- Good social skills improve interpersonal relationships and reduce loneliness.
- Training focuses on giving personal attention to others.
- Individuals learn to recognize and follow social norms.
- Mood regulation before social interaction improves communication.
- Training includes observation, modeling, role-playing, active listening, giving compliments, and telephone communication.
- Erwin (1994) found that social skills training improves social competence and satisfaction.

What is Intimacy?

Definition

- Intimacy refers to sharing one's innermost thoughts and feelings with another person.
- The word intimacy comes from the Latin word *intimus*, meaning "inner" or "inmost."
- Aron and Aron (1997) proposed that intimate relationships expand a person's self-concept.
- William James described the self as an object of attention.
- People respond to intimate partners in ways similar to how they respond to themselves.

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Inclusion of Others in the Self

- Close relationships lead people to include aspects of others within their own self-concept.
- Activating memories about oneself also activates memories about close partners.
- Greater inclusion results in stronger intimacy.

Self-Schemas

- Intimate partners gradually include each other's characteristics in their own self-concept.
- Shared personality traits become easier to recognize and remember.
- Self-other distinctions become less noticeable over time.

The Attribution Process

- People explain the behavior of loved ones similarly to how they explain their own behavior.
- Intimate partners make more favorable attributions for each other's actions.

Resource Allocation

- Close partners willingly share physical, emotional, and psychological resources.
- Sharing strengthens intimate relationships.

Communal vs. Exchange Relationships

Communal Relationships

- People help each other according to need.
- Rewards and costs are not carefully calculated.
- Love and care are the primary focus.

Exchange Relationships

- Relationships are based on rewards and costs.
- Individuals evaluate whether benefits outweigh costs.

Transactive Memory

- Intimate partners develop a shared memory system.
- Each partner remembers different types of information.
- Together, they remember more than either individual alone.
- Shared memory improves cooperation and communication.

Attachment as an Adaptive Response

- Attachment theory suggests that forming close relationships is biologically based.
- Human infants display attachment behaviors shortly after birth.

Infant Attachment Responses

- Rooting reflex helps infants locate their mother's breast.
- Moro reflex allows infants to grasp caregivers.
- Newborns recognize their mother's face, voice, and smell.

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- Infants imitate caregivers' facial expressions.
- Oxytocin promotes parental bonding and caregiving behavior.

John Bowlby's Attachment Theory (1969)

- Bowlby believed attachment protects vulnerable infants.
- Attachment is part of human evolutionary heritage.

Infant Responses to Separation

Protest

- Infants cry and seek their caregivers' attention.

Despair

- Continued separation leads to sadness and withdrawal.

Detachment

- Prolonged separation causes infants to become emotionally independent.

Parent-Child Attachment

- Attachment is the strong emotional bond between infants and caregivers.
- Secure attachment provides comfort and protection.
- Parent-child attachment forms the foundation for future relationships.

Attachment Styles and Later Adult Relationships

Secure Attachment

- People believe they are worthy of love.
- Others are viewed as trustworthy.
- Parents are caring and responsive.
- Securely attached individuals develop healthy relationships.

Insecure Attachment

- People believe they are unworthy of love.
- Others are viewed as unreliable.
- Parents are often neglectful or inconsistent.
- Insecure attachment reduces self-esteem and social competence.

Effects of Insecure Attachment

- Children often show approach-avoidance behavior.
- They may seek closeness and then withdraw.
- Social rejection strengthens feelings of insecurity.
- Attachment styles may change after major life experiences such as divorce or abuse.

Attachment Styles and Culture

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

- Culture influences attachment styles.
- Individualistic cultures encourage independence.
- American and German children are more likely to develop insecure attachment than Japanese children.
- Parenting practices shape attachment development.

New Concepts in Attachment Styles

Attachment depends on:

- Self-esteem.
- Trust in others.

Four Attachment Styles

Secure

- High trust.
- Positive self-esteem.
- Comfortable with intimacy.

Preoccupied

- Trusts others.
- Low self-esteem.
- Fear of abandonment.

Dismissing-Avoidant

- High self-esteem.
- Low trust.
- Avoids close relationships.

Fearful-Avoidant

- Low self-esteem.
- Low trust.
- Fears rejection and avoids intimacy.

Research on Attachment Styles

- Securely attached adults report warm family relationships during childhood.
- They develop lasting and satisfying intimate relationships.
- They handle conflicts effectively.
- Secure partners may help insecure partners develop healthier attachment patterns.

Important Exam Points

- Intimacy means sharing one's innermost thoughts and feelings.
- Aron and Aron proposed the Inclusion of Others in the Self theory.
- Self-schemas expand through close relationships.
- Communal relationships are based on needs rather than rewards.
- Transactive memory is a shared memory system between intimate partners.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

- Bowlby proposed Attachment Theory.
- Infant attachment includes protest, despair, and detachment.
- Secure attachment develops through responsive parenting.
- Insecure attachment develops through neglectful or inconsistent caregiving.
- Four attachment styles are Secure, Preoccupied, Dismissing-Avoidant, and Fearful-Avoidant.
- Secure attachment is associated with healthy adult relationships.
- Attachment styles can change after major life experiences.

Statement MCQs

1. Intimacy refers to:

- A. Competition between individuals
- B. Sharing one's innermost thoughts and feelings
- C. Avoiding close relationships
- D. Social comparison

Correct Answer: B

2. Bowlby's Attachment Theory states that attachment primarily serves to:

- A. Increase intelligence
- B. Protect vulnerable infants
- C. Promote competition
- D. Improve academic performance

Correct Answer: B

3. Secure attachment is characterized by:

- A. Low trust and fear of rejection
- B. High trust and positive self-esteem
- C. Avoidance of intimacy
- D. Emotional withdrawal

Correct Answer: B

4. Transactive memory refers to:

- A. Forgetting shared experiences
- B. A shared memory system between close partners
- C. Individual long-term memory
- D. Memory loss due to stress

Correct Answer: B

5. Which attachment style is characterized by low trust and avoidance of intimacy with low self-esteem?

- A. Secure
- B. Preoccupied
- C. Dismissing-Avoidant
- D. Fearful-Avoidant

Correct Answer: D

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Psychological Statement Q/A

1. What is intimacy?

Answer: Intimacy is the sharing of one's innermost thoughts, feelings, and experiences with another person, leading to psychological closeness.

2. What is transactive memory?

Answer: Transactive memory is a shared memory system in which intimate partners store, organize, and retrieve information together.

3. What is secure attachment?

Answer: Secure attachment is a style in which individuals view themselves as worthy of love and others as trustworthy, resulting in healthy relationships.

4. What are Bowlby's three infant responses to separation?

Answer: The three responses are protest, despair, and detachment.

5. How do attachment styles influence adult relationships?

Answer: Attachment styles affect trust, intimacy, emotional security, and the quality of romantic and social relationships throughout adulthood.

Lesson 31: SOCIAL INFLUENCE

Summarized Notes

Childhood Attachment Styles and Adult Romantic Relationships

- Until the mid-1980s, attachment research mainly focused on children and adolescents.
- Mary Ainsworth studied secure and insecure attachment styles in children.
- Cindy Hazan and Philip Shaver examined whether childhood attachment styles influence adult romantic relationships.
- In 1987, they developed self-report measures of attachment styles through a "love quiz."
- Securely attached adults reported healthier relationships with their parents than insecurely attached adults.
- Individualistic cultures place greater importance on love in marriage than collectivistic cultures such as Pakistan, India, Thailand, and the Philippines.

Sternberg's Triangular Theory of Love

- Passion is the hot component of love involving intense emotions, attraction, and physical arousal.
- Intimacy is the warm component involving closeness, trust, support, sharing, and mutual understanding.
- Commitment is the cool component involving the decision to love someone and maintain a long-term relationship.
- Companionate love develops over time through affection, closeness, concern, and shared experiences.

Attachment Styles and Friendship

- Friendships are voluntary relationships unlike family relationships.
- Superficial friendships are based mainly on rewards and exchange.
- Developed friendships are based on mutual concern, trust, and care.
- Self-disclosure is sharing personal information with others.
- Self-disclosure helps build strong friendships and reduces loneliness.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Social Penetration Theory

- Irwin Altman and Dalmas Taylor proposed Social Penetration Theory in 1973.
- Relationships develop gradually from discussing superficial topics to sharing intimate personal information.
- North Americans generally disclose more personal information than people from collectivistic cultures.
- Women tend to self-disclose more than men.

Part IV: Social Interactions

- Social influence explains how one person's behavior affects another person's behavior.
- Aggression focuses on harmful social interactions.
- Prosocial behavior studies why people help others.
- Group behavior examines how individuals behave in groups.
- Interpersonal power explains why people sometimes obey immoral authority.

Social Influence

Aims

- To introduce the concept of social influence.

Objectives

- To describe classic conformity studies.
- To evaluate major theories of social influence.

Chapter Summary

- Social influence includes conformity, compliance, and obedience.
- Conformity means changing behavior to match group standards.
- Compliance means responding to a request from another person or group.
- Obedience means following orders from a legitimate authority.
- Classic studies by Sherif, Asch, and Milgram explain different forms of social influence.
- Informational and normative influence are major causes of conformity.
- Factors such as group size, unanimity, cohesiveness, commitment, and minority influence affect conformity.
- Compliance techniques include foot-in-the-door, door-in-the-face, low-ball, that's-not-all, and pique technique.
- Milgram's obedience experiments showed how authority influences behavior.

Introduction to Social Influence

- Social influence is the exercise of social power to change people's attitudes or behavior.
- Religious, political, and social leaders often influence people's actions and beliefs.
- Public pressure can influence organizations and governments to change their actions.

Behavioral Consequences of Social Influence

Conformity

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

- Conformity is changing behavior or beliefs because of group pressure.
- Family, friends, teachers, and society influence conformity.
- Independence means making decisions without being controlled by others.

Compliance

- Compliance is publicly acting according to a direct request.
- A person may comply even if they privately disagree.

Obedience

- Obedience is performing an action in response to a direct order from authority.
- Obedience is learned from parents, teachers, police, and other authority figures.
- Obedience is generally stronger in traditional collectivistic cultures.

Classic Conformity Research

Norm Development (Muzafer Sherif, 1935)

- Muzafer Sherif studied how social norms develop in groups.
- He believed a group is more than simply a collection of individuals.

Phase 1: Autokinetic Effect

- Participants estimated the movement of a stationary light.
- The apparent movement was an optical illusion called the autokinetic effect.
- Individual estimates gradually became consistent.

Phase 2: Formation of Social Norms

- Participants publicly announced their estimates.
- Their judgments gradually became similar.
- A common group standard called a social norm developed.
- Participants believed their judgments were independent even though they were influenced by the group.
- Greater uncertainty increased conformity because people relied more on others' judgments.

Important Exam Points

- Secure attachment leads to healthier adult romantic relationships.
- Sternberg's Triangular Theory includes passion, intimacy, and commitment.
- Companionate love develops through long-term closeness and affection.
- Self-disclosure strengthens friendships and relationships.
- Social Penetration Theory explains that relationships develop through gradual self-disclosure.
- Social influence is the process of changing others' attitudes or behavior.
- Conformity means changing behavior because of group pressure.
- Compliance means responding to a direct request.
- Obedience means following orders from a legitimate authority.
- Sherif's autokinetic experiment demonstrated the development of social norms.
- Informational and normative influence are major causes of conformity.
- Uncertainty increases conformity.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Statement MCQs

1. Social influence is:

- A. A personality trait
- B. The exercise of social power to change attitudes or behavior
- C. A form of intelligence
- D. A type of memory

Correct Answer: B

2. According to Sternberg's Triangular Theory of Love, intimacy refers to:

- A. Physical attraction only
- B. Long-term commitment only
- C. Feelings of closeness, trust, and support
- D. Social popularity

Correct Answer: C

3. Self-disclosure refers to:

- A. Hiding personal information
- B. Revealing personal information to others
- C. Following social norms
- D. Obeying authority

Correct Answer: B

4. Sherif's autokinetic experiment demonstrated the development of:

- A. Personality traits
- B. Social norms
- C. Aggression
- D. Leadership styles

Correct Answer: B

5. Obedience is defined as:

- A. Changing beliefs because of peers
- B. Responding to a request only
- C. Performing an action in response to a direct order
- D. Ignoring authority

Correct Answer: C

Psychological Statement Q/A

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

1. What is social influence?

Answer: Social influence is the exercise of social power to change the attitudes or behavior of others.

2. What are the three components of Sternberg's Triangular Theory of Love?

Answer: Passion, intimacy, and commitment.

3. What is self-disclosure?

Answer: Self-disclosure is the sharing of personal information with others to develop closer relationships.

4. What is conformity?

Answer: Conformity is changing one's behavior or beliefs because of perceived group pressure.

5. What did Sherif's experiment demonstrate?

Answer: Sherif's experiment demonstrated that people develop common social norms when making judgments in uncertain situations.

Lesson 32: SOCIAL INFLUENCE (CONTINUED)

Summarized Notes

Aims

- To introduce the concept of conformity and related concepts.

Objectives

- To describe Asch's classic conformity experiments.
- To explain factors influencing conformity.
- To discuss Schachter's research on rejection of nonconformists.
- To describe minority influence.

Classic & Contemporary Conformity Research

- People often conform to the majority even when they privately disagree.
- Conformity is common in situations such as jury decision-making.
- The Rodney King jury case demonstrated how group pressure can influence individual judgments.

Asch's Experiments on Group Pressure (1951)

- Solomon Asch conducted a visual perception experiment.
- One participant was placed with six confederates.
- Participants identified which comparison line matched a standard line.
- Initially, confederates gave correct answers.
- Later, they unanimously selected incorrect answers.
- Participants conformed to the incorrect majority on about 37% of trials.
- Around 76% of participants conformed at least once.
- When judgments were made privately, errors dropped to about 1%.
- People often conformed because challenging a unanimous group was difficult.

Post-Conformity Change of Behavior

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

- After conforming, people often reconstruct events to justify their behavior.
- They convince themselves that the majority may have been correct.
- This helps maintain cognitive consistency and reduces psychological discomfort.

Two Sources of Group Pressure

Normative Influence

- Normative influence occurs when people conform to gain acceptance or avoid rejection.
- Fear of criticism, embarrassment, or punishment encourages conformity.
- This type of influence was most evident in Asch's experiments.

Informational Influence

- Informational influence occurs when people seek information from others in uncertain situations.
- Individuals assume that the majority is more likely to be correct.
- This type of influence was demonstrated in Sherif's experiments.
- Both normative and informational influence may occur together.

Schachter's Work on Rejection of the Nonconformist

- Stanley Schachter studied how groups react to members who disagree.
- Participants discussed the case of a juvenile delinquent named Johnny Rocco.
- Confederates intentionally expressed different opinions.
- Group members first tried to persuade the nonconformists.
- When persuasion failed, they excluded the nonconformists from future discussions.

Research Findings

- Groups are more likely to reject one or two nonconformists than several.
- Social rejection is one of the strongest forms of normative influence.
- Rejection may contribute to depression and loneliness.
- Many teenagers conform to peer pressure to gain acceptance.
- Adolescents are especially vulnerable because their attitudes are still developing.

Factors That Influence Conformity

Group Size

- Conformity increases as group size increases.
- The greatest effect occurs with groups of about three or four people.
- Adding more members beyond this has little additional effect.
- In ambiguous situations, even one or two people can strongly influence others.

Group Cohesiveness

- Group cohesiveness refers to the attraction and unity among group members.
- Highly cohesive groups produce greater conformity.
- Such groups place stronger pressure on members who disagree.

Social Support

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

- Social support reduces conformity.
- If even one person supports the participant, conformity decreases sharply.
- A single dissenter is often enough to break group pressure.
- Support must remain consistent; if the supporter changes sides, conformity returns.

Minority Influence

- A consistent and confident minority can influence the majority.
- History contains many examples of minority groups bringing social change.
- Minority opinions usually take longer to be accepted.
- Once accepted, minority influence often produces stronger and longer-lasting attitude change.
- Minority influence encourages people to think more carefully from different perspectives.

Moscovici's Experiment (1969)

- Serge Moscovici studied minority influence using a visual perception task.
- Participants judged whether slides were blue or green.
- Consistent minorities influenced majority judgments more than inconsistent minorities.
- Consistency increased the credibility of the minority viewpoint.

Conditions for Effective Minority Influence

- The minority should remain consistent and confident.
- The minority should also be flexible and open-minded.
- Minority influence is stronger when its ideas are close to accepted cultural values.
- Excessive rigidity reduces minority influence.

Example: Nelson Mandela

- Nelson Mandela successfully influenced the majority through consistency, confidence, and willingness to negotiate.
- His leadership demonstrated the power of constructive minority influence.

Important Exam Points

- Asch's experiment demonstrated conformity under group pressure.
- Participants conformed on about 37% of trials in Asch's study.
- Normative influence occurs to gain acceptance or avoid rejection.
- Informational influence occurs when people seek guidance in uncertain situations.
- Schachter found that groups first persuade and then reject nonconformists.
- Social rejection is a powerful form of normative influence.
- Conformity increases with group size up to about three or four members.
- Cohesive groups produce higher conformity.
- Social support reduces conformity.
- A consistent and confident minority can influence the majority.
- Moscovici demonstrated the effectiveness of consistent minority influence.
- Minority influence encourages divergent thinking and produces lasting attitude change.

Statement MCQs

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

1. Asch's conformity experiment mainly examined:

- A. Memory performance
- B. Group pressure on individual judgments
- C. Intelligence differences
- D. Personality development

Correct Answer: B

2. Normative influence occurs because people want to:

- A. Gain accurate information
- B. Avoid social rejection and gain acceptance
- C. Improve memory
- D. Increase intelligence

Correct Answer: B

3. Informational influence is strongest when:

- A. The situation is clear
- B. People are certain of their judgments
- C. The situation is ambiguous or uncertain
- D. There is no group present

Correct Answer: C

4. According to Schachter's research, groups usually react to persistent nonconformists by:

- A. Rewarding them
- B. Ignoring them completely
- C. Rejecting or excluding them
- D. Promoting them as leaders

Correct Answer: C

5. Minority influence is most effective when the minority is:

- A. Inconsistent and emotional
- B. Flexible, confident, and consistent
- C. Silent and passive
- D. Larger than the majority

Correct Answer: B

Psychological Statement Q/A

1. What did Asch's experiment demonstrate?

Answer: It demonstrated that people often conform to group pressure even when the group's answer is clearly incorrect.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

2. What is normative influence?

Answer: Normative influence is conformity motivated by the desire to gain social acceptance or avoid rejection.

3. What is informational influence?

Answer: Informational influence is conformity that occurs because people believe others have more accurate information.

4. How does social support affect conformity?

Answer: The presence of even one supporter greatly reduces conformity by breaking group unanimity.

5. What are the main conditions for successful minority influence?

Answer: The minority must be consistent, confident, flexible, open-minded, and present views that are close to accepted cultural values.

Lesson 33: SOCIAL INFLUENCE (CONTINUED)

Summarized Notes

Aims

- To introduce the concept of obedience in relation to social influence.

Objectives

- To describe the classic studies of obedience.
- To explain the factors that influence obedience.

Obedience

- Obedience is an overt and direct form of social influence.
- It involves following orders from a person who is perceived as a legitimate authority.
- Unlike conformity, obedience is based on explicit commands.
- People are more likely to disobey if the order involves serious harm or danger.
- Obedience depends on the belief that authority figures have the right to give orders.

Crimes of Obedience

- Crimes of obedience occur when people carry out immoral or illegal orders from authorities.
- The "Eichmann Defense" refers to Adolf Eichmann's claim that he was simply following orders during the Holocaust.
- This concept demonstrates how obedience can lead to unethical behavior.

Milgram's Experiments (1963)

- Stanley Milgram investigated obedience to authority.
- Participants acted as teachers while a confederate acted as the learner.
- Learners intentionally made mistakes in a word-pair task.
- Participants were instructed to deliver increasingly stronger electric shocks after each mistake.
- Only the first 15-volt shock was real; all remaining shocks were fake.
- The learner protested, screamed, and eventually became silent.
- The experimenter repeatedly instructed participants to continue.
- The highest shock level was 450 volts, labeled "XXX – Danger Severe Shock."

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Findings of Milgram's Experiment

- Experts predicted that almost nobody would obey to the maximum level.
- About 65% of participants obeyed until 450 volts.
- All participants continued up to 300 volts.
- Participants experienced stress, anxiety, trembling, sweating, and emotional conflict.
- The findings showed that ordinary people may obey authority even when it conflicts with personal morals.

Replications of Milgram's Study

- Similar obedience levels were found in Australia, Jordan, Germany, and other countries.
- Later studies by Meeus and Raaijmakers also found very high obedience levels.
- Obedience remained high even when participants were aware of the procedure beforehand.
- Obedience decreased when participants became legally responsible for the consequences.
- Modern research suggests obedience remains a powerful social influence.

Factors Affecting Obedience

Factors Increasing Obedience

- Seeing another person obey authority increases obedience.
- The physical presence of an authority figure strengthens obedience.
- The authority's expertise and status increase compliance with orders.

Factors Decreasing Obedience

- Greater distance between the authority and participant reduces obedience.
- Observing others refuse authority encourages resistance.
- When other participants rebel, obedience decreases significantly.

Gamson's Study on Resistance

- William Gamson studied resistance to unethical authority.
- Participants were asked to sign a false affidavit against an employee.
- Many participants questioned the request and resisted the authority.
- The study showed that group discussion and mutual support encourage disobedience.

Compliance

- Compliance is publicly acting according to a direct request.
- Compliance usually involves more thoughtful decision-making than conformity.

Factors That Increase Compliance

Positive Mood

- People in a positive mood are more helpful and cooperative.
- Pleasant emotions increase willingness to comply.

Reciprocity

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

- People feel obligated to return favors received from others.
- Doing a favor first increases the likelihood of receiving one in return.

Giving a Reason

- Providing a reason increases compliance, even if the reason is simple.
- People are more likely to agree when requests are explained.

Two-Step Compliance Techniques

Foot-in-the-Door Technique

- A small request is made first.
- After agreement, a larger request is presented.
- Initial compliance increases the chance of accepting the larger request.

Door-in-the-Face Technique

- A very large request is made first.
- After refusal, a smaller request is presented.
- The second request appears more reasonable.

Low-Ball Technique

- A reasonable request is accepted first.
- Additional costs or conditions are introduced later.
- People often remain committed to the original decision.

That's-Not-All Technique

- Extra benefits or discounts are offered before the person responds.
- The offer appears more attractive and increases compliance.

Social Impact Theory (Latane, 1981)

- Bibb Latané proposed Social Impact Theory.
- Social influence depends on three important factors:
 - Number of people influencing.
 - Strength or status of the influencing group.
 - Immediacy (physical and psychological closeness).
- Larger groups produce greater influence, but the effect gradually levels off.
- Social support weakens the overall impact of group pressure.

Important Exam Points

- Obedience is following direct orders from a legitimate authority.
- Crimes of obedience occur when immoral orders are obeyed.
- Milgram found that 65% of participants obeyed up to 450 volts.
- Participants experienced significant emotional stress during Milgram's experiment.
- Presence of authority increases obedience.
- Observing disobedience reduces obedience.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

- Positive mood increases compliance.
 - Reciprocity encourages people to return favors.
 - Giving reasons increases compliance.
 - Foot-in-the-door starts with a small request followed by a larger one.
 - Door-in-the-face starts with a large request followed by a smaller one.
 - Low-ball technique introduces hidden costs after initial agreement.
 - That's-not-all technique increases compliance by adding extra benefits.
 - Social Impact Theory states that influence depends on number, strength, and immediacy.
-

Statement MCQs

1. Obedience refers to:

- A. Changing behavior because of group pressure
- B. Following a direct order from a legitimate authority
- C. Sharing personal opinions with others
- D. Rejecting social norms

Correct Answer: B

2. According to Milgram's experiment, approximately what percentage of participants obeyed to the maximum 450 volts?

- A. 15%
- B. 35%
- C. 65%
- D. 95%

Correct Answer: C

3. Which compliance technique begins with a small request followed by a larger request?

- A. Door-in-the-face technique
- B. Low-ball technique
- C. Foot-in-the-door technique
- D. That's-not-all technique

Correct Answer: C

4. According to Social Impact Theory, social influence depends on:

- A. Intelligence, education, and personality
- B. Number, strength, and immediacy
- C. Age, gender, and culture
- D. Memory, learning, and motivation

Correct Answer: B

5. Reciprocity increases compliance because people:

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

- A. Enjoy competition
- B. Feel obligated to return favors
- C. Prefer working alone
- D. Fear punishment only

Correct Answer: B

Psychological Statement Q/A

1. Why did ordinary people obey harmful instructions in Milgram's experiment despite experiencing emotional distress?

Answer: Participants obeyed because they viewed the experimenter as a legitimate authority and felt responsible for following orders rather than making independent moral decisions.

2. How do the findings of Milgram's experiment explain the concept of "crimes of obedience"?

Answer: The findings show that ordinary individuals may perform unethical actions when they believe they are simply obeying legitimate authority.

3. Why does the presence of a rebellious peer reduce obedience?

Answer: Observing someone else resist authority provides social support, reduces fear of disobedience, and encourages independent decision-making.

4. Why is giving a reason effective in increasing compliance?

Answer: People naturally seek explanations for behavior, so providing a reason—even a simple one—makes a request appear more reasonable and acceptable.

5. How does Social Impact Theory explain differences in social influence?

Answer: It explains that social influence becomes stronger when more people exert influence, when they possess greater status or authority, and when they are physically or psychologically close to the individual.

Lesson 34: AGGRESSION

Summarized Notes

Journal Activity (Previous Lecture #33)

Personal Examples of Conforming

- Think of a situation where you changed your behavior because of real or imagined pressure from others.
- Most examples represent normative conformity that gradually becomes internalized through repeated behavior.

Aggression

Aims

- To introduce the psychological aspects of antisocial (aggressive) behavior.

Objectives

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

- To describe different types of aggression.
- To discuss gender differences in aggression.
- To explain personality differences in aggressive behavior.
- To describe different explanations of aggression.

Chapter Summary

- Aggression refers to behavior intended to harm others, oneself, or objects.
- Aggression can be antisocial, prosocial, or socially sanctioned.
- Anger should be distinguished from aggression because anger is an emotion whereas aggression is a behavior.
- Aggression is influenced by biological, psychological, social, and environmental factors.
- Frustration, learning, hormones, evolutionary factors, and media violence all contribute to aggression.
- Various methods such as learned inhibition, punishment, and non-aggressive modeling can reduce aggressive behavior.

Definition of Aggression

- Aggression is any behavior intended to harm another person, oneself, or an object.
- Aggression may be antisocial, socially approved (such as self-defense), or prosocial (such as law enforcement).
- Aggression involves intentional harmful behavior.
- Anger is an emotional state, whereas aggression is an action.
- Assertiveness differs from aggression because it expresses one's rights without harming others.

Identifying Aggression

- Intentionally firing a gun at someone is aggression even if the victim is not injured.
- Accidentally harming someone is not aggression because there is no intention to harm.
- Grabbing a doctor's moustache is physical aggression.
- Smashing a wall or damaging property is aggression toward objects.
- Kicking and damaging a waste container is aggression.
- Insulting or verbally criticizing someone is verbal aggression.
- Threatening or shouting at another person is also verbal aggression.

Types of Aggression

Instrumental Aggression

- Instrumental aggression is used to achieve another goal.
- The main objective is obtaining rewards or avoiding punishment.
- It is usually planned, deliberate, and rational.
- Robbery and military actions are examples of instrumental aggression.

Hostile Aggression

- Hostile aggression is driven by anger.
- The primary goal is to harm or injure another person.
- It is usually impulsive and emotional.
- Rewards are not the main motivation.

Gender Differences in Aggression

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

- Men generally show higher levels of physical aggression than women.
- Women often display indirect aggression.
- Indirect aggression includes gossiping, spreading rumors, revealing secrets, and social exclusion.
- Research suggests women are also capable of serious physical aggression under certain circumstances.

Personality and Aggression

- Gian Vittorio Caprara identified three personality traits linked to aggression.

Irritability

- The tendency to become angry easily after slight provocation.

Rumination

- The tendency to continue thinking about anger after a provoking event.

Emotional Susceptibility

- The tendency to experience feelings of discomfort, insecurity, and emotional vulnerability.

Self-Esteem and Aggression

- Aggression often occurs when people with high but fragile self-esteem feel threatened.
- Aggressive behavior may serve as a defense to protect self-esteem.

Explanations of Aggression

Biological Explanation

Evolutionary Perspective

- Some psychologists believe aggression evolved because it increased survival.
- Aggression may help protect resources, territory, and family.
- Aggression is often directed toward non-relatives.
- However, cultural differences show that aggression is also shaped by environmental influences.

Behavior Genetics

- Identical twins show more similar aggressive tendencies than fraternal twins.
- Both heredity and environment contribute to aggressive behavior.

Hormonal Activity

- Hormones influence aggression.
- Higher levels of testosterone are associated with greater aggression.
- Testosterone may increase competitiveness and dominance.
- Social and cultural factors still play a major role in determining aggressive behavior.

Frustration-Aggression Hypothesis

Catharsis

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

- John Dollard and colleagues proposed the Frustration-Aggression Hypothesis.
- Frustration occurs when people are prevented from achieving desired goals.
- Frustration creates a tendency toward aggression.
- Early theory suggested that expressing aggression reduces aggressive feelings through catharsis.

Evidence

- Economic hardship has been linked with increased violence and aggression.
- Rising unemployment has been associated with increased child abuse and violent behavior.

Does Catharsis Reduce Aggression?

- The idea of catharsis originated from Sigmund Freud.
- Research has found little evidence that expressing aggression reduces future aggression.
- Simply "letting off steam" does not eliminate aggressive tendencies.

Mallick and McCandless Study (1966)

- Children completed a block-building task.
- Some children experienced frustration during the task.
- Afterwards, they either played with a toy gun or talked with the experimenter.
- Later they had an opportunity to harm another child.
- Results showed that pretend aggression did not reduce later aggressive behavior.
- Make-believe violence does not effectively reduce aggression.

Important Exam Points

- Aggression is intentional behavior aimed at causing harm.
- Anger is an emotion, whereas aggression is a behavior.
- Assertiveness differs from aggression because it respects others' rights.
- Instrumental aggression is goal-oriented.
- Hostile aggression is motivated by anger.
- Men generally display more physical aggression, whereas women more often use indirect aggression.
- Irritability, rumination, and emotional susceptibility are personality traits related to aggression.
- High but unstable self-esteem may increase aggression.
- Evolutionary theory explains aggression as beneficial for survival.
- Testosterone is associated with increased aggressive behavior.
- Frustration-Aggression Hypothesis states that frustration increases aggressive tendencies.
- Research provides little support for the catharsis theory.
- Make-believe violence does not reduce aggressive behavior.

Statement MCQs

1. Aggression is best defined as:

- A. Any emotional reaction to stress
- B. Any behavior intended to harm a person, oneself, or an object
- C. Any disagreement with others
- D. Expressing personal opinions confidently

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Correct Answer: B

2. Instrumental aggression is primarily used to:

- A. Express anger only
- B. Achieve another goal or reward
- C. Reduce stress immediately
- D. Gain social approval only

Correct Answer: B

3. Hostile aggression is mainly motivated by:

- A. Financial rewards
- B. Careful planning
- C. Anger and the desire to harm
- D. Self-defense only

Correct Answer: C

4. According to research, which personality trait involves repeatedly thinking about anger after provocation?

- A. Assertiveness
- B. Rumination
- C. Optimism
- D. Sociability

Correct Answer: B

5. Research on catharsis suggests that:

- A. Expressing aggression always reduces future aggression
- B. Pretend violence completely removes aggressive feelings
- C. There is little evidence that catharsis reduces aggression
- D. Aggression disappears after emotional expression

Correct Answer: C

Psychological Statement Q/A

1. Why is anger not considered the same as aggression?

Answer: Anger is an emotional feeling, whereas aggression is intentional behavior aimed at causing harm. A person may feel angry without acting aggressively.

2. How does instrumental aggression differ from hostile aggression?

Answer: Instrumental aggression is used as a means to achieve another goal, whereas hostile aggression is driven by anger with the primary purpose of harming the victim.

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3. Why do psychologists believe high but fragile self-esteem can lead to aggression?

Answer: Individuals with unstable high self-esteem may react aggressively when they perceive criticism or threats because aggression helps protect their positive self-image.

4. Why does modern research reject the catharsis hypothesis?

Answer: Research shows that expressing aggression or engaging in pretend violence does not reduce aggressive tendencies and may even maintain aggressive behavior.

5. How do biological and environmental factors work together to influence aggression?

Answer: Biological factors such as genetics and hormones create a tendency toward aggression, while social, cultural, and environmental experiences determine how and when aggressive behavior is expressed.

Lesson 35: AGGRESSION (CONTINUED)

Summarized Notes

Aims

- To introduce psychological aspects of antisocial (aggressive) behavior.

Objectives

- To describe the cathartic hypothesis of aggression.
- To explain the Cognitive-Neo-associationist Model of aggression.
- To discuss situational factors involved in aggressive behavior.
- To describe the learning theory of aggression.

Implications of the Cathartic Hypothesis

- Catharsis suggests that expressing aggression reduces future aggression.
- Research shows little support for this belief.
- Verbal aggression often escalates into more serious aggression instead of reducing it.
- Families with little verbal aggression rarely experience physical violence.
- Domestic conflicts often progress from arguments to yelling and eventually physical aggression.
- Many media sources and mental health professionals still promote catharsis despite weak scientific evidence.

Cognitive-Neo-associationist Model

- Leonard Berkowitz developed the Cognitive-Neo-associationist Model.
- Frustration is only one of many causes of aggression.
- Other unpleasant experiences such as pain, extreme heat, or disliked people also produce negative emotions.
- These unpleasant experiences activate aggression-related thoughts stored in memory.

Cognitive-Associative Networks

- Negative emotions become connected with aggressive thoughts, feelings, and behaviors.
- When similar unpleasant situations occur, these aggressive memories become activated automatically.

Fight or Flight Responses

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- Negative events activate two possible responses:
- Aggressive (fight) response.
- Escape (flight) response.
- The response depends on:
- Genetic predisposition.
- Previous learning and experience.
- Situational cues that encourage or discourage aggression.

Unthinking Aggressive Responses

- Initial aggressive reactions are automatic and impulsive.
- They occur before careful thinking begins.

Higher-Order Cognitive Intervention

- Self-awareness allows individuals to control aggressive impulses.
- Cognitive control helps regulate emotions and choose more appropriate behavior.

Bushman's Study (2002)

- Brad J. Bushman tested the catharsis hypothesis.
- Participants first received insulting feedback on an essay.
- One group hit a punching bag while thinking about the person who insulted them.
- Another group hit the punching bag while thinking about physical fitness.
- A control group did not hit the punching bag.
- Participants who focused on the person who insulted them became the angriest and most aggressive.
- The findings supported Berkowitz's theory and rejected the catharsis hypothesis.

Situational Factors

Heat Hypothesis

- High temperatures increase hostile thoughts and aggressive behavior.
- Hot weather is associated with higher rates of riots, assaults, murders, rape, and domestic violence.
- People often become more irritable during extremely hot weather.
- Temperature-controlled environments may reduce aggressive behavior.
- Global warming may increase aggression because of rising temperatures.

Aggressive Cues (Triggers)

- Aggression-associated cues activate aggressive thoughts.
- Common aggressive cues include guns, knives, clubs, and other weapons.
- Negative attitudes and unpleasant surroundings can also trigger aggression.
- Weapons increase aggression mainly when individuals are already angry.
- Research shows that firearms in homes are more likely to harm family members than intruders.
- The effect of weapons depends on the meaning people attach to them.

Social Learning Theory

- Albert Bandura proposed that aggression is learned through observation and experience.
- People learn when, how, and against whom aggression should be directed.
- Learning occurs through observation, imitation, rewards, and punishment.
- The theory is based on operant conditioning principles.

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Rewards of Aggression

- Aggressive behavior that receives rewards is more likely to occur again.
- Rewards may be material, social, or psychological.
- When aggressive behavior is consistently not rewarded or punished, it gradually decreases through extinction.
- Inconsistent punishment makes aggressive behavior more resistant to extinction.

Observational Learning (Bandura, Ross & Ross, 1961)

- Children observed an adult behaving aggressively toward a Bobo doll.
- The adult punched, kicked, and hit the doll while shouting aggressive statements.
- Later, children imitated the same aggressive behaviors.
- Children copied both physical actions and verbal expressions.
- Children are more likely to imitate:
 - Parents and caregivers.
 - Authority figures.
 - Television and media models.
- Children learn aggressive behavior even when they observe the model being punished.
- Physical aggression is modeled more frequently than verbal aggression.
- Parents should avoid displaying aggressive behavior in front of children.

Important Exam Points

- Research does not support the catharsis hypothesis.
- Verbal aggression often escalates into physical aggression.
- Berkowitz's Cognitive-Neo-associationist Model explains aggression through negative emotions and cognitive associations.
- Fight or flight responses are activated by unpleasant events.
- Self-awareness helps regulate aggressive impulses.
- Bushman's study supported the Cognitive-Neo-associationist Model.
- Heat increases aggressive thoughts and behaviors.
- Weapons act as aggression-associated cues.
- Social Learning Theory explains aggression through observation and imitation.
- Rewards strengthen aggressive behavior.
- Extinction reduces aggression when rewards stop.
- Inconsistent reinforcement maintains aggressive behavior longer.
- Bandura's Bobo Doll experiment demonstrated observational learning.
- Children imitate aggressive role models, especially parents and authority figures.

Statement MCQs

1. According to research, the catharsis hypothesis states that aggression:

- A. Always increases after expression
- B. Is reduced by expressing hostile feelings
- C. Is caused only by hormones
- D. Cannot be controlled

Correct Answer: B

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2. According to Berkowitz's Cognitive-Neo-associationist Model, aggression is triggered mainly by:

- A. Intelligence
- B. Positive emotions
- C. Negative affect and unpleasant experiences
- D. Memory loss

Correct Answer: C

3. The Heat Hypothesis suggests that:

- A. Cold weather increases aggression
- B. High temperatures increase aggressive behavior
- C. Temperature has no effect on aggression
- D. Aggression occurs only indoors

Correct Answer: B

4. According to Social Learning Theory, aggression is mainly learned through:

- A. Observation, imitation, rewards, and punishment
- B. Dreams and imagination
- C. Genetic inheritance only
- D. Biological maturation alone

Correct Answer: A

5. Bandura's Bobo Doll experiment demonstrated that children:

- A. Ignore adult behavior completely
- B. Learn aggressive behavior by observing aggressive models
- C. Cannot imitate verbal aggression
- D. Only imitate rewarded behaviors

Correct Answer: B

Psychological Statement Q/A

1. Why does modern research reject the catharsis hypothesis?

Answer: Research shows that expressing aggression often strengthens aggressive thoughts and behaviors instead of reducing them, causing aggression to escalate rather than disappear.

2. How does Berkowitz's Cognitive-Neo-associationist Model explain aggressive behavior?

Answer: The model explains that unpleasant experiences create negative emotions, which activate aggression-related thoughts stored in memory and may produce aggressive responses unless controlled by higher-order thinking.

3. Why are weapons considered aggression-associated cues?

Answer: Weapons activate aggressive thoughts that are already stored in memory, making angry individuals more likely to behave aggressively.

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4. How does Social Learning Theory explain the development of aggressive behavior?

Answer: It explains that people learn aggression by observing role models, imitating their behavior, and repeating actions that receive rewards or reinforcement.

5. What did Bandura's Bobo Doll experiment demonstrate about children's learning?

Answer: It demonstrated that children readily imitate aggressive behaviors they observe in adults, showing that aggression can be learned through observation even without direct reinforcement.

Lesson 36: REDUCING AGGRESSION

Summarized Notes

Aims

- To introduce different social and psychological strategies to reduce aggression.

Objectives

- To describe various methods used to reduce aggression.
- To explain punishment as a method of controlling aggression.
- To discuss incompatible responses and reducing frustration.
- To describe teaching non-aggressive responses.

Introduction

- Legal systems commonly use punishment to control violent behavior.
- The most severe form of punishment is the death penalty.
- Punishment is effective only when it is:
 - Prompt.
 - Relatively strong.
 - Consistent.
- Major strategies for reducing aggression include:
 - Punishment.
 - Inducing incompatible responses.
 - Reducing frustration.
 - Teaching non-aggressive responses.

Punishment

- Punishment may temporarily reduce aggressive behavior.
- According to Social Learning Theory, aggressive punishment may become a model for others.
- Family violence often continues because children observe aggressive punishment.
- Punishment does not teach prosocial or peaceful behavior.
- Fear of punishment works only in the immediate situation.
- According to Berkowitz's Cognitive-Neo-associationist Model, punishment may increase anger and lead to counter-aggression.
- Large-scale punishment systems are expensive and difficult to maintain.

Incompatible Response Strategy

- People cannot experience two incompatible emotions at the same time.
- Replacing anger with another emotion reduces aggression.
- Robert Baron (1976) suggested that incompatible emotions can suppress aggressive behavior.

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Baron's Study (1976)

- Drivers were deliberately frustrated when a car blocked traffic for 15 seconds.
- Researchers observed drivers' aggressive reactions.
- Three experimental conditions were used:
 - Inducing empathy.
 - Creating humor.
 - Mild sexual arousal.
- Two control conditions included:
 - Simple distraction.
 - No intervention.
- Empathy, humor, and mild sexual arousal significantly reduced aggressive responses.

Reducing Frustration

- Frustration is an important cause of aggression.
- Governments attempt to reduce aggression by improving economic and social conditions.
- Pakistani studies (Suhail & Javed, 2002; Suhail & Khalid, 2006) found that many homicide offenders belonged to the middle social class and experienced greater social and psychological stress.
- Reducing frustration lowers aggression but cannot eliminate it completely.

Teaching Non-Aggressive Responses

- Aggression can be reduced by teaching peaceful methods of handling conflict.
- Important methods include:
 - Social modeling.
 - Internalizing anti-aggression beliefs.
 - Apologies.
 - Social skills training.
 - Reducing exposure to violence.

Social Modeling

- According to Social Learning Theory, people imitate peaceful role models.
- Watching non-aggressive models reduces aggressive behavior.
- Baron & Kepner (1970) found that participants who observed peaceful behavior later behaved less aggressively.
- Children imitate less television violence when adults openly condemn violent behavior (Horton & Santogrossi, 1978).

Internalizing Anti-Aggression Beliefs

- When peaceful beliefs become part of an individual's self-concept, aggression decreases.
- Huesmann et al. (1983) found that children who explained why television violence was wrong became less aggressive.

Apologies as Aggression Controllers

Ohbuchi et al. (1989)

- Japanese college students experienced failure because of an assistant's mistakes.
- The assistant either apologized or remained silent.
- Participants evaluated the assistant afterward.

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- A sincere public apology significantly reduced hostility.
- Simple apologies help repair damaged relationships and reduce anger.

Gender Differences in Apologizing

- Women are more willing to apologize and accept responsibility.
- Women apologize more when criticized.
- Men often avoid apologizing because they fear losing social status or "losing face."

Social Skills Training

- Peaceful interpersonal skills reduce aggressive behavior.
- Training includes:
 - Negotiation.
 - Compromise.
 - Cooperative problem solving.
 - Role-playing.
 - Modeling prosocial behavior.
- Guerra & Slaby (1990) found that a 12-session intervention improved social problem-solving skills and reduced aggressive beliefs among juvenile delinquents.

Reducing Exposure to Violence

Robinson et al. (2001)

- Third- and fourth-grade students reduced television and video-game use by one-third.
- Parents encouraged alternative home activities.
- Children exposed to less media violence displayed less aggression on the playground.

Important Exam Points

- Effective punishment must be prompt, strong, and consistent.
- Punishment reduces aggression temporarily but does not teach prosocial behavior.
- Aggressive punishment may become a model for future aggression.
- Berkowitz's Cognitive-Neo-associationist Model explains why punishment may increase anger.
- Incompatible emotions such as empathy and humor reduce aggression.
- Robert Baron's study supported the Incompatible Response Strategy.
- Reducing frustration lowers aggressive behavior but cannot remove it entirely.
- Social modeling teaches peaceful behavior through observation.
- Internalizing anti-aggression beliefs reduces violent behavior.
- Ohbuchi's study demonstrated that sincere apologies reduce hostility.
- Women apologize more readily than men.
- Social skills training improves conflict resolution and reduces aggression.
- Reducing exposure to violent media decreases aggressive behavior in children.

Statement MCQs

1. According to Social Learning Theory, punishment may sometimes increase aggression because:

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- A. It permanently removes aggressive behavior.
- B. Aggressive punishment becomes a model for imitation.
- C. It eliminates frustration.
- D. It reduces emotional learning.

Correct Answer: B

2. Robert Baron's Incompatible Response Strategy suggests that aggression is reduced when:

- A. Anger is encouraged.
- B. Two compatible emotions occur together.
- C. Anger is replaced by emotions such as empathy or humor.
- D. Punishment becomes more severe.

Correct Answer: C

3. According to Ohbuchi et al. (1989), a sincere apology mainly:

- A. Increases punishment.
- B. Reduces interpersonal hostility.
- C. Encourages revenge.
- D. Strengthens aggressive beliefs.

Correct Answer: B

4. Huesmann et al. (1983) found that children became less aggressive when they:

- A. Watched more violent television.
- B. Received physical punishment.
- C. Learned reasons why television violence was wrong.
- D. Were isolated from classmates.

Correct Answer: C

5. Robinson et al. (2001) demonstrated that reducing children's television and video-game exposure resulted in:

- A. Increased aggression.
- B. Greater academic stress.
- C. Less aggressive playground behavior.
- D. No behavioral change.

Correct Answer: C

Psychological Statement Q/A

1. Why is punishment alone not considered an effective long-term method for reducing aggression?

Answer: Punishment may temporarily suppress aggressive behavior but does not teach prosocial alternatives. It can also increase anger and serve as an aggressive model for others to imitate.

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2. How does the Incompatible Response Strategy reduce aggression?

Answer: It reduces aggression by replacing anger with emotions such as empathy, humor, or mild positive feelings, since incompatible emotions cannot occur strongly at the same time.

3. Why does social modeling reduce aggressive behavior?

Answer: According to Social Learning Theory, people learn peaceful behaviors by observing and imitating non-aggressive role models, especially authority figures and parents.

4. How do apologies function as aggression controllers?

Answer: A sincere apology reduces hostility, repairs damaged relationships, and decreases feelings of anger by acknowledging responsibility for the harm caused.

5. Why is reducing exposure to violent media considered an effective strategy for reducing aggression?

Answer: Violent media provide aggressive models for observational learning. Reducing exposure limits imitation of aggressive behaviors and encourages more peaceful social interactions.

Lesson 37: PROSOCIAL BEHAVIOR

Summarized Notes

Aims

- To introduce psychological aspects of prosocial behavior.

Objectives

- To describe different types of helping behavior.
- To discuss different explanations of helping behavior.
- To evaluate the Bystander Intervention Model.

Prosocial Behavior

- Prosocial behavior refers to voluntary actions intended to benefit another person.
- Helping behavior may involve little or great personal cost.
- Helping may be motivated by self-interest or concern for others.

Definitions

Prosocial Behavior

- Voluntary behavior performed to benefit another person.

Egoistic Helping

- Helping with the ultimate goal of increasing one's own welfare.
- The helper expects some personal benefit or reward.

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Altruistic Helping

- Helping another person without expecting any reward.
- The main goal is the welfare of the other person.

Types of Helping (McGuire, 1994)

- Casual help (e.g., giving directions).
- Substantial help (e.g., lending money).
- Emotional help (e.g., listening and providing support).
- Emergency help (e.g., saving someone's life or helping during a crisis).

Explanations of Helping Behavior

- Evolutionary Perspective.
- Sociocultural Perspective.
- Learning Perspective.

Evolutionary Perspective

- Helping behavior increases survival and reproductive success.
- Helpful behaviors can be passed from one generation to another.
- Evolution favors behaviors that improve gene survival.

Kin Selection

- People are more likely to help blood relatives.
- Helping relatives increases the chances that shared genes will survive.
- Animals also show greater helping toward genetically related individuals.

Reciprocal Helping

- People often help strangers with the expectation that help will be returned in the future.
- Reciprocal helping develops when:
 - Individuals live in social groups.
 - Survival depends on cooperation.
 - There are no strict dominance hierarchies.
- People often feel guilt or shame when they cannot return a favor.

Social Norms

Norm of Reciprocity

- People should return favors and kindness received from others.
- This norm helps maintain fairness in social relationships.

Norm of Responsibility

- People should help individuals who are dependent or in need.
- Helping should occur without expecting rewards.
- Parents, teachers, police officers, and firefighters often follow this norm.

Norm of Social Justice

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- People help individuals they believe deserve assistance.
- Those who are seen as good or deserving receive greater help.

Learning Perspective

- Helping behavior is learned through observation and reinforcement.
- Models teach individuals how to help and what consequences helping brings.

Observational Learning in Children

- Children imitate helpful behavior shown by adults.
- Charitable adult models increase children's generosity.
- Both actions and verbal encouragement influence children's helping behavior.

Prosocial Modeling in Adults

- Adults also imitate helping behavior they observe.
- Seeing another person help increases the likelihood of helping later.
- Observing blood donation by others increases willingness to donate.

Rewarding Prosocial Behavior

- Praise strengthens future helping behavior.
- Social rewards are more effective than material rewards.
- Punishment or criticism decreases future helping.
- Positive reinforcement encourages generosity for a long time.

Bystander Intervention Model (Latané & Darley)

- Helping occurs through a series of decision-making steps.
- A person must successfully complete each step before helping.

Five Steps of the Bystander Intervention Model

- Notice that something unusual is happening.
- Interpret the situation as an emergency.
- Accept personal responsibility.
- Decide how to help.
- Take action and provide assistance.

Factors Reducing Helping

- Stimulus overload in crowded places reduces noticing emergencies.
- Population density is negatively related to helping behavior.
- Presence of many bystanders reduces personal responsibility.
- Uncertainty about what to do may prevent helping.

Important Exam Points

- Prosocial behavior is voluntary behavior intended to benefit others.
- Egoistic helping benefits the helper, while altruistic helping benefits others without expecting rewards.

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- Four types of helping are casual, substantial, emotional, and emergency helping.
- Evolutionary theory explains helping through gene survival and kin selection.
- Kin selection encourages helping blood relatives.
- Reciprocal helping is based on returning favors.
- Three important social norms are reciprocity, responsibility, and social justice.
- Helping behavior is learned through observation and reinforcement.
- Adult role models strongly influence children's helping behavior.
- Praise increases future helping, while punishment reduces it.
- Latané and Darley's Bystander Intervention Model explains how people decide whether to help.
- The five stages are notice, interpret, accept responsibility, decide how to help, and take action.
- Crowded environments and the presence of many bystanders reduce helping behavior.

Statement MCQs

1. Prosocial behavior is defined as:

- A. Any behavior intended to punish others
- B. Voluntary behavior intended to benefit another person
- C. Behavior motivated only by rewards
- D. Competitive behavior

Correct Answer: B

2. According to the evolutionary perspective, kin selection encourages people to help:

- A. Complete strangers only
- B. Blood relatives
- C. Authority figures only
- D. Friends only

Correct Answer: B

3. The Norm of Reciprocity states that people should:

- A. Help only family members
- B. Return favors received from others
- C. Avoid helping strangers
- D. Help only when rewarded

Correct Answer: B

4. According to Latané and Darley's Bystander Intervention Model, helping begins when a person first:

- A. Accepts responsibility
- B. Notices that something unusual is happening
- C. Calls the police
- D. Decides how to help

Correct Answer: B

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5. According to research, which type of reinforcement most effectively increases future helping behavior?

- A. Material rewards only
- B. Social praise
- C. Physical punishment
- D. Financial penalties

Correct Answer: B

Psychological Statement Q/A

1. What is the difference between egoistic helping and altruistic helping?

Answer: Egoistic helping is motivated by personal benefit or reward, whereas altruistic helping is performed solely for another person's welfare without expecting anything in return.

2. How does the evolutionary perspective explain helping behavior?

Answer: Evolutionary theory explains that helping behaviors increase the survival of genes through mechanisms such as kin selection and reciprocal helping.

3. What are the three major social norms that influence helping behavior?

Answer: The three social norms are the norm of reciprocity, the norm of responsibility, and the norm of social justice, all of which encourage helping under different circumstances.

4. How does observational learning influence prosocial behavior?

Answer: Individuals learn helping behaviors by observing role models, and they are more likely to help when they see helping behavior being rewarded or encouraged.

5. What are the five stages of the Bystander Intervention Model?

Answer: The five stages are noticing the event, interpreting it as an emergency, accepting responsibility, deciding how to help, and taking action to provide assistance.

Lesson 38: PROSOCIAL BEHAVIOR (CONTINUED)

Summarized Notes

Aims

- To introduce psychological aspects of prosocial behavior.

Objectives

- To discuss different explanations of helping behavior.
- To evaluate the Bystander Intervention Model.
- To discuss psychological processes that prevent helping.
- To describe Emotional Arousal and Cost-Reward Assessments.
- To describe individual variables affecting prosocial behavior.

Bystander Intervention

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- Two important psychological processes reduce helping behavior.
- These are:
- Audience inhibition effect.
- Diffusion of responsibility.

Audience Inhibition Effect

- People hesitate to help because they fear negative evaluation by others.
- They worry that the situation may not actually be an emergency.
- The presence of calm bystanders discourages helping.

Latané & Darley's Smoke Experiment (1968)

- Participants completed questionnaires in a room.
- Smoke slowly entered the room through a vent.
- Three conditions were tested:
- Participant alone.
- Participant with three other participants.
- Participant with two passive confederates.
- Participants alone reported the smoke most often.
- The presence of passive others greatly reduced helping.

Latané & Rodin's Woman in Distress Study (1969)

- Participants heard a woman apparently injured in another room.
- When alone, about 70% offered help.
- When passive confederates were present, only about 7% helped.
- The presence of unconcerned others strongly reduced intervention.

Explanations of Audience Inhibition

Informational Influence

- People observe others to decide whether a situation is an emergency.
- If others appear calm, individuals assume no help is needed.

Normative Influence

- People avoid helping because they fear embarrassment or negative judgment.
- They prefer to maintain a calm appearance in uncertain situations.

Diffusion of Responsibility

- People feel less personally responsible when others are present.
- Responsibility is shared among all bystanders.
- As the number of bystanders increases, helping decreases.

Darley & Latané's Seizure Experiment (1968)

- Participants believed they were discussing personal problems through an intercom.
- One speaker appeared to experience an epileptic seizure.
- Helping decreased as group size increased.
- Participants often denied that others influenced their decision.

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Diffusion of Responsibility on the Internet

- Online helping is also reduced when many people are present.
- Markey (2000) found that help was delayed in larger chat groups.
- Naming a specific person greatly increased helping.

Emotional Arousal and Cost-Reward Model (Piliavin et al., 1981)

- Emergencies create emotional arousal and discomfort.
- People evaluate the costs and benefits before helping.
- Costs of helping include:
 - Time.
 - Effort.
 - Risk of injury.
 - Embarrassment.
- Costs of not helping include:
 - Guilt.
 - Anxiety.
 - Social disapproval.
- If both helping and not helping are costly, people may:
 - Seek indirect help (call police or ambulance).
 - Redefine the situation to avoid helping.

Who Helps?

Positive Mood

- People in a good mood are more likely to help others.
- Good moods increase attention to others' needs.
- Helping maintains positive feelings.
- Happy people view others more positively.
- Good moods increase expectations of rewarding social interactions.

Factors That Improve Mood

- Sunny weather.
- Finding money.
- Receiving a pleasant treat.
- Listening to uplifting music.
- Watching comedy.

Negative Mood

- Mild negative moods may also increase helping.
- Helping reduces guilt and improves mood.
- Guilty individuals often help more than others.
- Extremely negative moods such as depression may reduce helping because attention focuses on personal distress.

Cunningham's Guilt Study (1980)

- Participants accidentally believed they had damaged a camera.
- Later, they saw a woman drop papers.

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- About 80% of guilty participants helped.
- Only about 40% of non-guilty participants offered help.

Negative State Relief Model

- Proposed by Cialdini and Kenrick.
- People help during negative moods if helping is expected to improve their feelings.
- Helping depends on perceived rewards and costs.
- If helping is rewarding and easy, negative mood increases helping.
- If helping is difficult or unrewarding, negative mood reduces helping.

Important Exam Points

- Audience inhibition reduces helping because people fear negative evaluation.
- Informational influence causes people to rely on others to define emergencies.
- Normative influence discourages helping to avoid embarrassment.
- Diffusion of responsibility reduces personal responsibility when many bystanders are present.
- Darley and Latané's experiments demonstrated the bystander effect.
- Diffusion of responsibility also occurs in online environments.
- Piliavin's Cost-Reward Model explains helping through emotional arousal and cost-benefit analysis.
- People may seek indirect help when direct helping is costly.
- Positive moods generally increase helping behavior.
- Mild guilt or sadness may increase helping through the Negative State Relief Model.
- Extremely negative moods often reduce helping because attention remains focused on oneself.
- Sunny weather, rewards, music, and comedy all increase helping behavior.

Statement MCQs

1. Audience inhibition occurs because people:

- A. Feel physically tired
- B. Fear negative evaluation from others
- C. Lack empathy
- D. Have low intelligence

Correct Answer: B

2. Diffusion of responsibility means that:

- A. Responsibility increases as group size increases
- B. People feel less personally responsible when others are present
- C. Only authority figures should help
- D. Helping becomes easier in large groups

Correct Answer: B

3. According to Piliavin's Cost-Reward Model, people decide to help after evaluating:

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- A. Their personality traits only
- B. The costs and benefits of helping and not helping
- C. Their education level
- D. Their physical strength

Correct Answer: B

4. According to the Negative State Relief Model, people in a bad mood are more likely to help when:

- A. Helping is expected to improve their mood
- B. Helping is extremely dangerous
- C. There are many bystanders
- D. They receive no personal benefit

Correct Answer: A

5. Latané and Darley's research mainly demonstrated the:

- A. Halo Effect
- B. Bystander Effect
- C. Mere Exposure Effect
- D. Self-Serving Bias

Correct Answer: B

Psychological Statement Q/A

1. What is audience inhibition and how does it affect helping behavior?

Answer: Audience inhibition is the tendency to avoid helping because people fear being negatively judged if the situation is not actually an emergency, resulting in delayed or reduced helping.

2. How does diffusion of responsibility reduce helping behavior?

Answer: When several bystanders are present, individuals feel that someone else will help, reducing their own sense of responsibility and making intervention less likely.

3. How does Piliavin's Emotional Arousal and Cost-Reward Model explain helping?

Answer: The model explains that emergencies create emotional discomfort, and people decide whether to help by comparing the costs of helping with the costs of not helping.

4. Why does a positive mood increase helping behavior?

Answer: Positive moods increase attention to others, improve perceptions of people, and encourage helping because it maintains pleasant emotions and rewarding social interactions.

5. What does the Negative State Relief Model suggest about helping behavior?

Answer: It suggests that people experiencing mild negative emotions help others when they believe helping will reduce guilt or improve their mood, but severe negative moods often decrease helping.

Lesson 39: GROUP BEHAVIOR

Summarized Notes

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Aims

- To introduce the psychological effects of being in a group and of interacting with others on an inter-individual level.

Objectives

- To describe the basic features of groups.
- To discuss the effects of groups on individuals.
- To describe social facilitation.

Gender Differences in Helping

- Men are more likely to perform heroic and risky helping behaviors.
- Men are more likely to help strangers, especially women, in dangerous situations.
- Women are more likely to provide emotional and social support.
- Women are more likely to care for children and older adults.
- Women are generally more helpful in everyday caregiving situations.
- Gender differences become stronger as people grow older and when gender roles are emphasized.

Applying Social Psychology to Increase Helping

- Teaching people about barriers to helping increases prosocial behavior.
- Awareness of the bystander effect encourages people to help during emergencies.
- Knowledge helps people overcome hesitation and become more responsive.

What is a Group?

- A group consists of two or more people who interact regularly.
- Group members share common goals.
- Members depend on one another.
- Members recognize themselves as belonging to the same group.

Basic Features of Groups

Social Norms

- Social norms are shared rules about acceptable behavior.
- Norms guide members' actions and expectations.
- They increase conformity within the group.
- They improve group performance by encouraging cooperation and discipline.

Social Roles

- Social roles are expected patterns of behavior assigned to group members.
- Roles may develop naturally or be carried from previous experiences.

Social Status

- Social status refers to prestige, authority, and power within a group.
- High-status members receive more attention and influence decisions.
- They usually have greater confidence and higher self-esteem.
- They are judged more harshly when poor decisions affect the group.

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Group Cohesiveness

- Cohesiveness is the force that keeps members together.
- Cohesive groups encourage cooperation and commitment.
- Positive factors include:
 - Mutual liking.
 - Effective teamwork.
 - Achievement of group goals.
- Negative factors include:
 - High cost of leaving the group.
 - Lack of alternative groups.

Effects of Groups on Individuals

- Groups influence individual behavior in several ways.
- Three important group effects are:
 - Social facilitation.
 - Social loafing.
 - Deindividuation.

Social Facilitation

- Social facilitation is the improvement of dominant responses in the presence of others.
- Performance improves on easy or well-learned tasks.
- Performance declines on difficult or unfamiliar tasks.
- Norman Triplett first demonstrated this effect with cyclists.
- Similar effects have been observed in both humans and animals.

Drive Theory (Zajonc, 1965)

- The presence of others increases physiological arousal.
- Increased arousal strengthens dominant responses.
- Correct dominant responses improve performance.
- Incorrect dominant responses reduce performance.
- Easy tasks produce social facilitation.
- Difficult tasks produce social inhibition.

Supporting Research

- Meta-analyses confirmed Zajonc's Drive Theory.
- Michaels et al. (1982) found that skilled pool players improved when observed.
- Poor players performed worse when others watched.
- Cockroach experiments also supported social facilitation and inhibition.

Evaluation Apprehension Theory

- Cottrell proposed that people perform differently because they fear being evaluated.
- Social facilitation occurs mainly when observers can evaluate performance.
- Blindfolded observers produce little or no facilitation because evaluation is impossible.

Distraction-Conflict Theory

- The presence of others divides attention.
- Conflict between focusing on the task and attending to others creates arousal.

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- Increased arousal strengthens dominant responses.
- Performance improves on simple tasks but decreases on complex tasks.
- Non-social distractions such as loud noises can produce similar effects.

Mere Presence Theory

- Zajonc argued that simply being around others creates arousal.
- Evaluation is not always necessary.
- Even passive observers may increase performance on simple tasks.
- Open office environments may improve routine work but reduce creativity.

Important Exam Points

- A group consists of interacting individuals with shared goals and interdependence.
- The four basic features of groups are social norms, social roles, social status, and cohesiveness.
- Social norms increase conformity and improve group performance.
- Social facilitation improves performance on simple tasks but impairs performance on difficult tasks.
- Norman Triplett conducted the first study on social facilitation.
- Zajonc's Drive Theory explains social facilitation through increased arousal.
- Easy tasks produce facilitation, while difficult tasks produce inhibition.
- Michaels et al. (1982) supported Drive Theory using pool players.
- Evaluation Apprehension Theory states that concern about being judged affects performance.
- Distraction-Conflict Theory explains arousal through divided attention.
- Mere Presence Theory suggests that simply being around others increases arousal.

Statement MCQs

1. According to Zajonc's Drive Theory, the presence of others primarily increases:

- A. Intelligence
- B. Physiological arousal
- C. Memory capacity
- D. Creativity

Correct Answer: B

2. Social facilitation usually improves performance on:

- A. Difficult and unfamiliar tasks
- B. Complex mathematical problems only
- C. Simple and well-learned tasks
- D. Tasks requiring no practice

Correct Answer: C

3. Evaluation Apprehension Theory states that people perform differently because they:

- A. Want to avoid competition
- B. Fear being evaluated by others

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- C. Prefer working alone
- D. Ignore the audience completely

Correct Answer: B

4. According to Distraction-Conflict Theory, social facilitation occurs because:

- A. People become physically stronger
- B. Attention is divided between the task and surrounding people
- C. Others always provide assistance
- D. People memorize tasks faster

Correct Answer: B

5. Group cohesiveness refers to:

- A. Competition between members
- B. The forces that keep members together and committed to the group
- C. Individual intelligence levels
- D. Leadership style only

Correct Answer: B

Psychological Statement Q/A

1. What is social facilitation?

Answer: Social facilitation is the improvement of dominant or well-learned responses when people perform tasks in the presence of others, while difficult tasks may suffer due to increased arousal.

2. How does Zajonc's Drive Theory explain social facilitation?

Answer: Zajonc proposed that the presence of others increases physiological arousal, which strengthens dominant responses. This improves performance on easy tasks but impairs performance on difficult tasks.

3. What is Evaluation Apprehension Theory?

Answer: Evaluation Apprehension Theory states that people perform differently because they are concerned about being observed and judged by others.

4. How does Distraction-Conflict Theory explain changes in performance?

Answer: The theory explains that attention is divided between performing the task and attending to other people, creating arousal that strengthens dominant responses and affects performance.

5. What are the basic features of a group?

Answer: The basic features of a group are social norms, social roles, social status, and group cohesiveness, which guide behavior and maintain unity among members.

Lesson 40: GROUP BEHAVIOR (CONTINUED)

Summarized Notes

Aims

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

- To introduce the psychological effects of being in a group and of interacting with others on an inter-individual level.

Objectives

- To introduce the concept of social loafing and discuss classic and contemporary research.
- To discuss the concept of deindividuation.

Social Loafing

- Social loafing is the reduction in individual effort when people work in groups.
- It occurs when individual contributions cannot be identified.
- People work less hard because responsibility is shared among group members.
- Social loafing occurs when personal efforts are hidden within the group.
- Social facilitation occurs when individual performance can be evaluated.

Early and Contemporary Research

- Max Ringelmann (1913) first demonstrated social loafing using rope-pulling tasks.
- People exerted less effort when pulling together than when working alone.
- Latane (1979) asked participants to shout as loudly as possible.
- Participants believed they were shouting with others, although they were actually shouting alone.
- Participants shouted less intensely when they believed they were part of a group.
- Social loafing occurs because responsibility is diffused among group members.
- It has been observed in both individualistic and collectivistic cultures.

Task Complexity and Social Loafing

- Jackson and Williams (1985) studied social loafing using a difficult computer maze.
- Participants were told they would be evaluated either individually or collectively.
- Collective evaluation improved performance on difficult tasks.
- Reduced evaluation apprehension allowed participants to concentrate better.
- On complex tasks, lower arousal can improve performance.

Social Compensation

- Karau and Williams (1993) explained that social loafing depends on:
- The importance of individual contribution.
- The value placed on group success.
- Social compensation occurs when individuals work harder to make up for weaker group members.
- People increase their effort when they care about the quality of the group's performance.

Reducing Social Loafing

- Make each person's contribution identifiable.
- Allow members to evaluate their own and the group's performance.
- Reward high group productivity.
- Make tasks meaningful, challenging, and interesting.
- Use social pressure or ostracism to discourage loafing.
- Women generally show less social loafing than men because they tend to be more group-oriented.

Social Loafing Across Cultures

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

- Social loafing has been observed in many countries including India, Thailand, Japan, and China.
- It is generally stronger in individualistic cultures than collectivistic cultures.
- Whether social loafing occurs depends on:
 - Identifiability of individual performance.
 - Task complexity.
 - Importance of group success.
 - Loyalty to the group.
 - Gender differences.

Deindividuation

- Deindividuation occurs when people lose self-awareness and personal responsibility within a group.
- It commonly occurs in large, anonymous, and emotionally arousing situations.
- Individuals become more likely to display aggressive or antisocial behavior.
- Anonymity reduces feelings of accountability.

Situational Factors Leading to Deindividuation

- Zimbardo (1970) identified several factors:
 - Large group size.
 - Stimulus overload.
 - Altered states of consciousness.
 - Anonymity.
 - High emotional arousal.
 - Noncognitive interactions.
 - Diffusion of responsibility.
 - Anonymous individuals behave more aggressively than identifiable individuals.

Internet-Induced Deindividuation

- Online anonymity can increase inappropriate behavior.
- Demetriou and Silke (2003) found that many Internet users attempted to access illegal material when they believed it was available.
- Virtual groups may encourage conformity and reduce personal responsibility.

Explanations of Deindividuation

- Diener (1980) argued that reduced self-awareness is the key factor.
- People focus less on personal values and more on the immediate situation.
- Deindividuation shifts attention from personal identity to group identity.
- Individuals become more likely to follow group norms, whether positive or negative.

Important Exam Points

- Social loafing is the reduction of individual effort in group work.
- Social loafing occurs when individual contributions cannot be identified.
- Max Ringelmann conducted the first social loafing experiment.
- Latane's shouting experiment demonstrated social loafing.
- Difficult tasks may reduce social loafing because lower evaluation apprehension improves concentration.
- Social compensation occurs when individuals work harder to support weak group members.
- Social loafing can be reduced through individual accountability and meaningful tasks.

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

- Social loafing is generally greater in individualistic cultures.
- Deindividuation occurs when anonymity reduces self-awareness and responsibility.
- Zimbardo identified anonymity, group size, and diffusion of responsibility as causes of deindividuation.
- Diener explained deindividuation through reduced self-awareness.
- Online anonymity can increase deindividuated behavior.

Statement MCQs

1. Social loafing refers to:

- A. Increased individual effort in groups
- B. Reduced individual effort when working in groups
- C. Working faster alone than in groups
- D. Improving performance through competition

Correct Answer: B

2. The first empirical study on social loafing was conducted by:

- A. Zajonc
- B. Bandura
- C. Max Ringelmann
- D. Zimbardo

Correct Answer: C

3. According to Karau and Williams (1993), social compensation occurs when individuals:

- A. Reduce their effort in groups
- B. Work harder to compensate for weaker group members
- C. Avoid difficult tasks
- D. Refuse to cooperate with others

Correct Answer: B

4. Deindividuation is most likely to occur when people experience:

- A. High self-awareness and accountability
- B. Anonymity within a large group
- C. Individual performance evaluation
- D. Personal recognition and rewards

Correct Answer: B

5. According to Diener (1980), the main psychological cause of deindividuation is:

- A. High intelligence
- B. Reduced self-awareness
- C. Strong leadership
- D. Emotional stability

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Correct Answer: B

Psychological Statement Q/A

1. What is social loafing?

Answer: Social loafing is the tendency for individuals to reduce their effort when working in a group because their individual contribution cannot be identified or evaluated.

2. How can social loafing be reduced?

Answer: Social loafing can be reduced by making individual contributions identifiable, rewarding performance, setting meaningful tasks, and increasing accountability within the group.

3. What is social compensation?

Answer: Social compensation occurs when individuals increase their effort to make up for weaker group members because they value the group's success.

4. What is deindividuation?

Answer: Deindividuation is a psychological state in which people lose self-awareness and personal responsibility, making them more likely to engage in impulsive or antisocial behavior within a group.

5. How did Diener explain deindividuation?

Answer: Diener explained that deindividuation results from reduced self-awareness, causing individuals to ignore personal values and follow the immediate group's norms instead.

Lesson 41: GROUP BEHAVIOR (CONTINUED)

Summarized Notes

Aims

- To introduce the psychological effects of being in a group and of interacting with others on an inter-individual level.

Objectives

- To describe the process of group decision making.
- To evaluate the effects of Groupthink.

David Dodd's Exercise on Deindividuation

- David Dodd designed an exercise to demonstrate deindividuation.
- Participants answered anonymously what they would do if they were completely invisible for 24 hours.
- They were assured they would not be detected or punished.
- About 36% of college students reported antisocial behaviors.
- This percentage was similar to responses from inmates in a maximum-security prison.
- The study showed that anonymity can increase antisocial intentions.

Group Decision Process

Risky Shift

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

- Stoner (1961) introduced the concept of the Risky Shift.
- People often make riskier decisions after discussing problems in groups.
- Management students first made decisions individually.
- After group discussion, they accepted greater risks.
- Later studies confirmed similar findings across different cultures, occupations, and age groups.
- Some studies found that groups sometimes became more cautious instead of riskier.

Group Polarization

- Group Polarization means group discussion strengthens members' initial attitudes.
- If members initially favor risk, they become even riskier.
- If members initially favor caution, they become even more cautious.
- Polarization is stronger for important issues.

Research on Group Polarization

- Myers & Bishop (1970) found that groups became more prejudiced or less prejudiced after discussion depending on their initial attitudes.
- McCauley & Segal (1987) found terrorist groups became increasingly extreme over time.
- Myers & Kaplan (1976) found juries developed stronger opinions regarding guilt or innocence after discussion.

Explanations of Group Polarization

Social Comparison

- People compare their opinions with others.
- They try to match or exceed socially valued positions.
- This reflects normative influence because people want social approval.

Mutual Persuasion

- Group discussion introduces new supporting arguments.
- Members become convinced by additional information.
- This reflects informational influence because people want the correct answer.

Isenberg's Meta-analysis

- Daniel Isenberg analyzed 21 studies of group polarization.
- Both social comparison and persuasive arguments contribute to stronger group decisions.
- Intellectual tasks rely more on persuasive arguments.
- Judgmental tasks rely more on social comparison.

Groupthink

- Irving Janis (1982) introduced the concept of Groupthink.
- Groupthink is the deterioration of judgment caused by excessive desire for agreement.
- Members avoid disagreement to maintain group harmony.
- Poor decisions result because alternatives are not properly evaluated.

Iraq War Example

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

- The 2003 Iraq invasion is often cited as an example of Groupthink.
- Decision makers strongly believed Iraq possessed weapons of mass destruction.
- Important opposing evidence was ignored.
- Later investigations found no such weapons.

Causes of Groupthink

High Group Cohesiveness

- Strongly attached members prefer agreement over criticism.
- Conformity increases within highly cohesive groups.

Threatening Situations

- Stress increases dependence on the group.
- Members value quick decisions rather than accurate decisions.

Structural and Procedural Faults

- Directive leadership encourages agreement.
- Lack of outside opinions limits critical thinking.
- Poor decision-making procedures increase Groupthink.

Turner et al.'s Study (1992)

- Turner and colleagues investigated Groupthink experimentally.
- High-cohesiveness groups were given names and identity tags.
- Low-cohesiveness groups received no group identity.
- High-threat groups believed their performance would be evaluated.
- Highly cohesive groups under threat made poorer decisions.
- The findings supported Janis's Groupthink theory.

Symptoms of Groupthink

Overestimation of the Group

- Members believe the group cannot fail.
- They have an illusion of invulnerability.
- Members believe their decisions are morally correct.

Close-mindedness

- Members ignore opposing evidence.
- They justify existing decisions instead of evaluating alternatives.

Increased Conformity

- Members suppress personal doubts.
- Dissenters are discouraged or rejected.
- Members falsely believe everyone agrees.

Tetlock's Study (1992)

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

- Tetlock analyzed ten historical decision-making events.
- Poor decisions showed many Groupthink characteristics.
- Common features included:
 - Suspicion of outsiders.
 - Restricting information.
 - Punishing disagreement.

Overcoming Groupthink

- Leaders should remain neutral during discussions.
- Members should be encouraged to express disagreement.
- Separate subgroups should evaluate the same problem independently.
- Outside experts should review important decisions.
- Critical evaluation improves decision quality.

Important Exam Points

- David Dodd demonstrated the effects of anonymity through deindividuation.
- Risky Shift was introduced by Stoner (1961).
- Group Polarization strengthens existing group attitudes.
- Social Comparison explains polarization through normative influence.
- Mutual Persuasion explains polarization through informational influence.
- Isenberg concluded both explanations contribute to polarization.
- Groupthink was proposed by Irving Janis.
- Groupthink results in poor decision-making due to excessive conformity.
- Major causes of Groupthink include cohesiveness, stress, and directive leadership.
- Symptoms include illusion of invulnerability, close-mindedness, and conformity.
- Turner et al. supported the effects of cohesiveness and threat on poor decisions.
- Tetlock found historical evidence supporting Groupthink.
- Neutral leadership, outside experts, and encouraging dissent reduce Groupthink.

Statement MCQs

1. According to Stoner (1961), the Risky Shift refers to:

- A. Individuals becoming less confident alone
- B. Groups making riskier decisions after discussion
- C. People avoiding all risks in groups
- D. Groups refusing to make decisions

Correct Answer: B

2. Group Polarization means that group discussion:

- A. Eliminates differences among members
- B. Weakens initial attitudes
- C. Strengthens members' initial attitudes
- D. Makes everyone neutral

Correct Answer: C

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3. According to Janis, Groupthink mainly occurs because of:

- A. Excessive desire for consensus
- B. Lack of communication
- C. High intelligence of members
- D. Random decision-making

Correct Answer: A

4. Which factor increases the likelihood of Groupthink?

- A. Neutral leadership
- B. Outside expert opinions
- C. High group cohesiveness and stress
- D. Independent decision-making

Correct Answer: C

5. One effective method for reducing Groupthink is to:

- A. Punish disagreement
- B. Prevent criticism
- C. Encourage dissent and consult outside experts
- D. Allow only the leader to decide

Correct Answer: C

Psychological Statement Q/A

1. What is the Risky Shift phenomenon?

Answer: Risky Shift is the tendency for groups to make riskier decisions after discussion than individuals would make alone.

2. How does Group Polarization affect group decisions?

Answer: It strengthens members' existing attitudes, making risky groups riskier and cautious groups more cautious after discussion.

3. What is Groupthink according to Janis?

Answer: Groupthink is poor decision-making caused by excessive pressure for agreement, where members suppress criticism and ignore alternative viewpoints.

4. What are the major causes of Groupthink?

Answer: High group cohesiveness, stressful situations, directive leadership, lack of outside opinions, and poor decision-making procedures increase the likelihood of Groupthink.

5. How can organizations reduce Groupthink?

Answer: Organizations can reduce Groupthink by encouraging open disagreement, keeping leaders neutral, using independent subgroups, and consulting outside experts.

Lesson 44: SOCIAL PSYCHOLOGY APPLIED – SOCIAL PSYCHOLOGY IN CLINIC

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

Summarized Notes

Aims

- To understand the use of social psychology theories and principles in clinical settings.

Objectives

- To discuss clinicians' biases in making clinical judgments.
- To discuss the relationship between faulty cognitions and mental and physical illness.
- To describe social-psychological approaches to reverse maladaptive behavior.
- To explain the relationship between positive resources and well-being.

Social Psychology in Clinical Settings

- Social psychology applies its principles to mental and physical health.
- It explains how thoughts, emotions, and social interactions influence well-being.
- Four major questions are studied:
 - How can clinical judgments be improved?
 - How do thinking patterns contribute to psychological problems?
 - How can maladaptive thinking be changed?
 - How do supportive relationships improve health and happiness?

Making Clinical Judgments

- Clinical judgments are social judgments and are vulnerable to bias.
- Clinicians may make errors because of illusory correlations, hindsight bias, and overconfidence.
- James Maddux (1993) concluded that clinicians are vulnerable to judgment errors.

Illusory Correlations

- Illusory correlation means perceiving relationships that do not actually exist.
- Some clinicians believe ambiguous test results predict personality traits.
- Loren Chapman and Jean Chapman (1969, 1971) showed clinicians often perceived expected relationships even when evidence did not support them.
- Expectations influence interpretation of psychological tests.

Hindsight Bias

- Hindsight bias is the belief that an event was predictable after it has occurred.
- People often think suicide or tragedy should have been predicted.
- Goggin and Range (1985) found people believed suicide was more predictable after learning it had occurred.
- Hindsight bias can create unnecessary guilt in family members and therapists.

Rosenhan's Experiment (1973)

- David Rosenhan tested the accuracy of psychiatric diagnosis.
- Healthy individuals reported hearing voices to gain admission.
- Most were diagnosed with schizophrenia.
- They behaved normally after admission but remained hospitalized.
- Hospital staff interpreted normal behavior as evidence of mental illness.
- A later follow-up found hospital staff wrongly suspected genuine patients of being fake.

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Overconfidence

- Clinicians often seek information that confirms their expectations.
- Snyder and Swann (1984) found interviewers asked questions that supported their initial beliefs.
- This creates self-confirming diagnoses.

Clinical vs. Statistical Prediction

- Clinicians often trust intuition more than statistical methods.
- Paul Meehl (1986) found statistical prediction is generally more accurate than expert intuition.
- Objective evidence usually predicts outcomes better than personal judgment.

Social Cognition and Problem Behaviors

Social Cognition and Depression

- Depressed people view themselves and the future negatively.
- They magnify failures and minimize successes.
- Mildly depressed people sometimes show depressive realism by making more accurate judgments.
- Sweeney et al. (1986) found depressed people commonly show a negative explanatory style.

Depression and Negative Thinking

Depression Causes Negative Thinking

- Depressed mood makes people remember experiences more negatively.
- Hirt et al. (1992) found temporary failure produced more pessimistic thinking.
- Depression also causes withdrawal and social rejection.

Negative Thinking Causes Depression

- A pessimistic explanatory style increases the risk of depression.
- Alloy et al. (1999) found optimistic students rarely experienced depression compared to pessimistic students.
- Depression develops into a vicious cycle of negative thoughts and experiences.

Social Cognition and Loneliness

- Loneliness is the feeling that social relationships are less satisfying than desired.
- It does not always mean being physically alone.
- Lonely people often perceive others negatively.
- Adolescents experience loneliness more frequently than adults.
- Men feel lonely when isolated from groups.
- Women feel lonely when lacking close personal relationships.

Social Cognition and Anxiety

- Shyness is a form of social anxiety.
- Shy people worry excessively about others' opinions.
- They overestimate how much others notice and judge them.
- Excessive self-consciousness increases anxiety.

Social Cognition and Illness

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Reactions to Illness

- People decide whether symptoms indicate illness.
- Social beliefs influence how symptoms are interpreted.
- Some illnesses may be socially constructed.

Emotions and Illness

- Anger-prone Type A personalities are at greater risk for heart disease.
- Stress hormones contribute to physical illness.

Optimism and Health

- Optimistic people generally experience better long-term health.
- Peterson et al. (1988) found optimism predicted better health later in life.
- Optimism also improves resistance to common illnesses.

Stress and Illness

- High stress weakens the immune system.
- Major life events increase vulnerability to illness.
- Exam stress, bereavement, and major life changes reduce immune functioning.

Explanatory Style and Health

- A negative explanatory style is associated with poorer mental and physical health.
- Optimistic thinking promotes recovery and resilience.

Social-Psychological Approaches to Treatment

Inducing Internal Change Through Behavior

- Behavior therapy changes behavior first to improve thoughts and emotions.
- Assertiveness training gradually develops confidence.
- Rational-emotive therapy encourages new ways of thinking and acting.

Breaking Vicious Cycles

- Depression, loneliness, and anxiety reinforce themselves.
- Therapy aims to interrupt these negative cycles.
- Changing thoughts, behavior, or environment can improve mental health.

Social Skills Training

- Social skills training teaches effective communication and interaction.
- Practice in safe situations increases confidence.
- Improved social behavior reduces loneliness and depression.

Explanatory Style Therapy

- Therapy teaches people to replace pessimistic explanations with optimistic ones.
- Mary Anne Layden (1982) used attribution retraining with depressed students.
- Positive explanatory styles increased self-esteem and reduced depression.

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Maintaining Positive Change

- Long-lasting improvement occurs when people believe success comes from their own efforts.
- Internal attributions strengthen recovery.
- Lasting change occurs through thoughtful personal understanding.

Social Support and Well-being

Close Relationships and Health

- Strong social relationships improve physical health.
- Social support reduces the risk of illness and early death.
- Widowed individuals have a higher risk of illness and mortality.
- Social support improves cardiovascular and immune functioning.

Close Relationships and Happiness

- Friendships increase happiness by sharing joy and reducing sorrow.
- Married people generally report greater life satisfaction than divorced or isolated individuals.
- Strong family and community bonds reduce loneliness and stress.

Important Exam Points

- Clinical judgments are affected by illusory correlations, hindsight bias, and overconfidence.
- Loren Chapman explained illusory correlations in clinical judgments.
- Rosenhan's (1973) experiment showed weaknesses in psychiatric diagnosis.
- Snyder and Swann demonstrated self-confirming diagnoses.
- Paul Meehl found statistical prediction is generally more accurate than clinical intuition.
- Depression is linked with negative explanatory styles.
- Depressive realism refers to mildly depressed people making relatively accurate judgments.
- Loneliness is not the same as physical isolation.
- Optimism improves both mental and physical health.
- Stress weakens the immune system.
- Behavior therapy, social skills training, and explanatory style therapy help reverse maladaptive behavior.
- Social support promotes health, happiness, and longer life.

Statement MCQs

1. Illusory correlation refers to:

- A. Remembering every event accurately
- B. Perceiving relationships that do not actually exist
- C. Ignoring all psychological tests
- D. Forgetting previous experiences

Correct Answer: B

2. Rosenhan's (1973) experiment demonstrated that:

PSY403 IMPORTANT NOTES + EXAM KEY POINTS + LECTURE WISE MCQS

- A. Psychological diagnoses are always accurate
- B. Healthy people were correctly identified immediately
- C. Psychiatric diagnoses can be influenced by expectations and labels
- D. Statistical prediction is less accurate than intuition

Correct Answer: C

3. According to Paul Meehl (1986), which method generally predicts outcomes more accurately?

- A. Personal intuition
- B. Statistical prediction
- C. Guesswork
- D. Projective testing only

Correct Answer: B

4. Depressive realism refers to the tendency of mildly depressed people to:

- A. Ignore reality completely
- B. Make relatively accurate judgments
- C. Become highly optimistic
- D. Avoid all social situations

Correct Answer: B

5. Which therapeutic approach teaches people to replace pessimistic explanations with optimistic ones?

- A. Psychoanalysis
- B. Explanatory Style Therapy
- C. Electroconvulsive Therapy
- D. Drug Therapy

Correct Answer: B

Psychological Statement Q/A

1. What is an illusory correlation?

Answer: Illusory correlation is the tendency to perceive a relationship between two events or traits even when no real relationship exists.

2. What did Rosenhan's (1973) study demonstrate?

Answer: Rosenhan showed that psychiatric diagnoses can be influenced by labels and expectations, causing normal behavior to be interpreted as signs of mental illness.

3. How does a negative explanatory style affect mental health?

Answer: A negative explanatory style increases pessimism, makes people expect failure, and increases the likelihood of depression.

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4. How does social support influence health?

Answer: Social support strengthens physical and mental health, improves immune functioning, reduces stress, and increases overall well-being.

5. How can maladaptive thinking patterns be changed?

Answer: They can be changed through behavior therapy, social skills training, explanatory style therapy, and encouraging positive internal attributions for success.

Lesson 45: FINAL REVIEW

Summarized Notes

Aims

- To understand the syllabus and content of social psychology in relation to important questions of interest.

Objectives

- To discuss various theoretical concepts of social psychology.
- To describe the link between various concepts of social psychology.
- To discuss the practicality of social psychology concepts.

Final Review

- The Social Psychology syllabus is divided into five sections.
- The first four sections cover theoretical concepts.
- The fifth section applies these concepts to real-life settings.

Section I: Overview of Social Psychology

Introduction

- Gordon Allport (1985) defined Social Psychology as the scientific study of how people's thoughts, feelings, and behaviors are influenced by the actual, imagined, or implied presence of others.
- Social behavior is influenced by:
 - Evolutionary and cultural factors.
 - Childhood experiences and family history.
 - Personality traits and attitudes.

Social Psychology and Related Fields

- Social Psychology is closely related to:
 - Sociology.
 - Biology.
 - Personality Psychology.

Profession of Social Psychology

- PhD-level social psychologists mainly work in universities.
- M.Sc.-level graduates work in various professional fields.

History of Social Psychology

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- Modern Social Psychology developed from 1884 onward.
- The field expanded through scientific research and experimentation.

Conducting Social Psychology Research

- Scientific research follows systematic steps:
- Develop a research question.
- Review previous literature.
- Form a theory or hypothesis.
- Define variables operationally.
- Choose an appropriate research design.
- Consider ethical issues.
- Collect data.
- Analyze results.
- Report conclusions.

Research Methods

- Observation studies behavior directly.
- Correlational research examines relationships between variables.
- Experimental research identifies cause-and-effect relationships.
- Other methods include:
- Meta-analysis.
- Internet research.
- Brain imaging.
- Virtual environment technology.

Section II: Thinking About the Self and Others

The Self

- Modern self-theories are based on George Herbert Mead and William James.
- The "I" is the active self.
- The "Me" is knowledge about oneself.
- Culture and family influence self-schema.
- Self-esteem affects self-evaluation.

Knowing the Self

- People understand themselves by:
- Reflecting on personal characteristics.
- Comparing themselves with others.
- Using social situations.

Person Perception

- People form impressions through:
- Facial expressions and body language.
- Verbal communication and paralanguage.
- Physical gestures.

Impression Formation

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- Central traits strongly influence impressions.
- Peripheral traits have less influence.
- Impressions are formed using:
 - Averaging principle.
 - Implicit personality theory.
 - Halo effect.
 - Primacy effect.
 - Recency effect.

Attribution

- Attribution explains the causes of behavior.
- Heider (1958) proposed locus of causality.
- Weiner (1982) added stability and controllability.

Attribution Biases

- Fundamental Attribution Error.
- Actor-Observer Bias.
- False Consensus Effect.
- Self-Serving Bias.
- Ultimate Attribution Error.

Social Cognition

- People understand the social world through:
 - Social categorization.
 - Schemas.

Cognitive Shortcuts

- Representativeness heuristic.
- Availability heuristic.

Thinking Biases

- Hindsight bias.
- Counterfactual thinking.
- Confirmation bias.
- Self-fulfilling prophecy.
- Belief in a Just World.
- Learned helplessness.

Section III: Evaluating Persons and Relationships

Attitudes

- Attitudes consist of:
 - Affective component.
 - Behavioral component.
 - Cognitive component.

Attitude Formation

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- Mere exposure.
- Classical conditioning.
- Operant conditioning.
- Self-perception theory.
- Facial feedback.
- Functional approach.

Attitude Change

- Cognitive dissonance.
- Persuasion.
- Message variables.
- Audience variables.

Prejudice and Discrimination

Causes of Prejudice

- Cognitive categorization.
- Emotional factors such as scapegoating and authoritarian personality.
- Social inequality.
- Social identity.
- Social competition.

Reducing Prejudice

- Contact hypothesis.
- Recategorization.

Interpersonal Attraction

Situational Factors

- Proximity.
- Familiarity.
- Anxiety.

Personal Factors

- Physical attractiveness.
- Similarity.
- Desirable personal qualities.

Close Relationships

- Childhood attachment styles influence adult relationships.
- Attachment styles include:
 - Secure.
 - Preoccupied.
 - Dismissing-avoidant.
 - Fearful-avoidant.

Section IV: Social Interactions

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Social Influence

- Conformity.
- Obedience.
- Compliance.

Aggression

Explanations of Aggression

- Biological theory.
- Catharsis theory.
- Cognitive Neoassociation Theory.
- Social Learning Theory.

Reducing Aggression

- Punishment.
- Encouraging incompatible responses.
- Reducing frustration.
- Teaching non-aggressive behavior.

Prosocial Behavior

- Reasons people help others.
- Situations that encourage helping.
- Bystander Intervention Model.
- Emotional arousal and Cost-Reward Model.
- Effects of mood and gender on helping behavior.

Group Behavior

Effects of Groups

- Social facilitation.
- Social loafing.
- Deindividuation.

Group Decision-Making

- Group decisions.
- Groupthink.

Leadership

- Major theories of leadership.
- Types of leadership.
- Sources of leaders' power.

Section V: Social Psychology Applied

Social Psychology in Court

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- Social psychology explains eyewitness testimony.
- It studies factors affecting jury decisions.
- It improves legal procedures and courtroom judgments.

Social Psychology in Clinic

- Social psychology explains clinical judgments.
- It studies depression, anxiety, loneliness, and illness.
- It applies cognitive and behavioral techniques to improve mental health.
- Social support promotes health and well-being.

Important Exam Points

- Gordon Allport defined Social Psychology in 1985.
- Social Psychology studies how others influence thoughts, feelings, and behavior.
- Scientific research follows systematic research steps.
- Observation, correlational, and experimental methods are the major research methods.
- The "I" and the "Me" are key concepts of self-theory.
- Impression formation involves central traits, halo effect, primacy, and recency.
- Major attribution biases include Fundamental Attribution Error and Self-Serving Bias.
- Social cognition depends on schemas and heuristics.
- Attitudes consist of Affective, Behavioral, and Cognitive (ABC) components.
- Cognitive dissonance explains attitude change.
- Contact hypothesis helps reduce prejudice.
- Attachment styles influence adult relationships.
- Social influence includes conformity, obedience, and compliance.
- Major aggression theories include Biological, Catharsis, Cognitive Neoassociation, and Social Learning Theory.
- Group behavior includes social facilitation, social loafing, deindividuation, and Groupthink.
- Leadership includes trait, situational, contingency, transformational, and transactional theories.
- Social Psychology is widely applied in court and clinical settings.

Statement MCQs

1. According to Gordon Allport (1985), Social Psychology is the scientific study of:

- A. Brain functioning only
- B. Human learning in schools
- C. How people's thoughts, feelings, and behaviors are influenced by others
- D. Animal behavior only

Correct Answer: C

2. Which research method is best for identifying cause-and-effect relationships?

- A. Observation
- B. Correlational research
- C. Experimental research
- D. Survey research

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Correct Answer: C

3. Which attachment style is generally associated with healthy adult relationships?

- A. Fearful-avoidant
- B. Dismissing-avoidant
- C. Secure
- D. Preoccupied

Correct Answer: C

4. Which theory explains attitude change by reducing inconsistency between beliefs and behavior?

- A. Social Learning Theory
- B. Cognitive Dissonance Theory
- C. Attribution Theory
- D. Contact Hypothesis

Correct Answer: B

5. Which section of Social Psychology focuses on the practical application of psychological principles?

- A. Section I
- B. Section II
- C. Section III
- D. Section V

Correct Answer: D

Psychological Statement Q/A

1. What is the main focus of Social Psychology?

Answer: Social Psychology studies how the actual, imagined, or implied presence of others influences people's thoughts, feelings, and behaviors.

2. What are the major research methods used in Social Psychology?

Answer: The major research methods are observation, correlational research, and experimental research, along with meta-analysis and modern technologies.

3. What are the three components of attitude?

Answer: The three components are Affective (feelings), Behavioral (actions), and Cognitive (beliefs), commonly known as the ABC model.

4. What are the major forms of social influence?

Answer: The major forms are conformity, obedience, and compliance, which explain how people are influenced by others.

5. How is Social Psychology applied in everyday life?

Answer: Social Psychology is applied in courts to improve eyewitness testimony and jury decisions, and in clinics to understand mental health, change maladaptive thinking, and promote well-being.

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